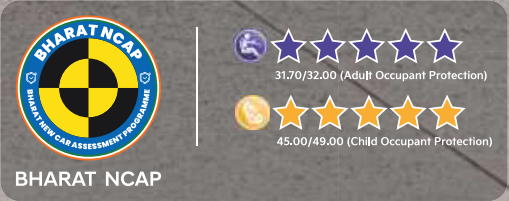


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INNOCEAN-020/26

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QUICKLY.

Gold holds steady as focus turns to West Asia tensions

Gold prices held steady on Tuesday, as investors monitored escalating hostilities in West Asia and braced for minutes from the US Fed's June meeting for guidance on the monetary policy outlook. Spot gold was little changed at \$4,168.62 per ounce at 09:01 am ET, while US gold futures for August delivery rose 0.3 per cent to \$4,180.50. REUTERS

Aluminium gains on supply disruption fears

Aluminium prices rose on Tuesday as markets weighed potential supply tightness amid West Asia tensions and continued outflows from visible inventories. Benchmark three-month aluminium on the London Metal Exchange gained 0.5 per cent, to \$3,129 a tonne at 1009 GMT, approaching resistance coming from the 200-day moving average at \$3,161. In June, aluminium fell 16 per cent, its biggest monthly decline since the 2008 global financial crisis as peace talks between US and Iran fuelled optimism that Gulf supplies via Hormuz would resume. REUTERS

Australia suspends 60% of Indian fumigation service providers

COMPLIANCE DRIVE. Suspension of 44 service providers follows a biosecurity audit conducted on July 2

Prabhaddatta Mishra
Subramani Ra Mancombu
New Delhi/Chennai

Australia has suspended the licences of 60 per cent of fumigation service providers in India, after an audit by Australian biosecurity.

The suspension of these 44 service providers, including 5 from Haryana and 3 from Punjab, was made last week.

This could result in some exporters having to pay additional charges for re fumigation of the consignments once they land in Australia.

Containers in transit are not exempt from such division. If any suspended fumigation provider fumigates a consignment, it would have to be re fumigated in Australia on arrival.

"This process will add up additional cost of fumigation...", the department said. The additional costs could vary from (Australian dollar



ADDED EXPENSE. The ban could result in some exporters having to pay additional charges for re fumigation of their consignments once they land in Australia

A\$700 to A\$1,200 per container. (A\$1=₹66.14).

The owner of a fumigation agency, which services channel partners of some leading Basmati exporters, said on the condition of anonymity that officials conducted the inspection on July 2 and verbally communicated their decision the next day.

ONE-TIME EXEMPTION
Though he is yet to receive any formal communication from the Australian author-

ity, he also saw it on their website.

Over 100 containers of basmati rice will likely be affected by this suspension. If one container of rice is valued at \$22,000, at least ₹200 crore worth of consignments are at risk of either getting rejected or made to go through costlier re fumigation, said an affected exporter. According to a communication from the Australian Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and

Forestry, during the past few years, Canberra had moved from document-based approval toward continuous compliance monitoring and surprise audits. Australia operates one of the world's strictest biosecurity systems. Even relatively small procedural failures may result in suspension.

Basmati rice exporters expressed concern over the development, saying re fumigation would result in additional costs. Haryana and Punjab exporters said they had taken it up with the Agricultural and Processed Food Products Development Authority and the Union Ministry of Agriculture, as its plant quarantine wing is the main body governing fumigation. Sources said the government is considering seeking a one-time exemption for rice shipments in transit and certified by the suspended entities. The fumigation firm owner said the Australian authorities got suspicious after

they found a discrepancy in the dates of fumigation and packing. They wondered how consignments could be packed earlier than the fumigation date. The owner, who fumigates 5-6 containers of basmati a month, said that while fumigation is done when the rice is in gunny bags, the agency had no clue how the exporter packs the aromatic rice.

S Chandrasekaran, a New Delhi-based trade analyst, said the forthcoming India-Australia Comprehensive Economic Cooperation Agreement (CECA) should consider a special chapter on pre-border Biosecurity and Quality Control and Schemes Cooperation.

"Such a chapter could provide joint accreditation and periodic audits of off-shore treatment and inspection providers, notification and technical consultation before suspension, except in genuine emergencies," he said.

NCDEX to relaunch black pepper futures on July 15

Our Bureau
Mumbai

NCDEX has decided to relaunch black pepper futures. It will revive one of its most significant contracts and restore a pricing mechanism, which was missing in the commodity markets for over a decade and a half. The contract will start trading from July 15.

Initially, four contracts expiring in August, September, October and November will be available for trading.

As part of its expansion plans, the exchange is planning to launch equity trading

in the cash segment and to venture into mutual fund distribution by end of July.

NCDEX recently raised ₹770 crore to strengthen the exchange platform and venture into new business.

TRADING REVIVAL

Arun Raste, Managing Director and CEO of NCDEX, said India was one of the world's largest producers and consumers of black pepper but had gradually ceded its role in global price discovery for the commodity.

The relaunch of black pepper futures is an effort to bring that benchmark home to create a transparent, cred-



ible and India-centric reference price for the trade, he added.

A robust derivatives market will help farmers, processors, exporters and traders manage volatility more effectively, while

strengthening India's position in the global spice ecosystem, he said.

EQUITY AND MF TRADING
The exchange also plans to venture into facilitating trading in equities and to take up distribution of mutual funds as part of business diversification.

An announcement on a mutual fund platform launch is expected by July-end, said Raste.

FILLING THE GAP

Even as NCDEX grows into a multi-asset exchange, it will remain committed to the commodity segment, enhan-

cing the product basket, he said.

Kedar Deshpande, Chief Business Officer of NCDEX, said with no active global derivatives benchmark currently available for black pepper, the relaunch fills a genuine and long-standing gap. It gives the spice ecosystem, from growers to exporters, a transparent, regulated platform for pricing and risk management, while reinforcing India's position in global spice trade, he said.

In 2010, NCDEX suspended the black pepper futures contract following severe quality disputes, including mineral oil adulteration in

exchange-accredited warehouses. This resulted in litigation, frozen trading and legal hurdles that lasted over a decade. However, the exchange has received SEBI nod to relaunch the contract now.

The exchange has now revised contract specifications incorporating enhanced quality parameters aligned with FSSAI standards.

These include stricter norms relating to moisture content and mouldy berries, among other quality measures, to strengthen quality assurance and mitigate the risk of adulteration, said the exchange.

Crude oil gains after attack on vessels near Strait of Hormuz

Reuters

Crude oil prices rose on Tuesday as reports of attacks on vessels near the Strait of Hormuz revived fears of disruptions to shipping through the critical energy transit route.

Brent crude futures gained 89 cents, or 1.24 per cent, to \$72.88 a barrel, while US West Texas Intermediate crude rose 71 cents, or 1.04 per cent, to \$69.26 a barrel at 0939 GMT.

MAIN DRIVER

"The overriding theme this morning is a ship being shot at in the Strait of Hormuz," Saxo Bank analyst Ole Hansen said.

"That's bringing some geopolitical risk premium back into the price. It's not a lot compared with what we've seen in the past, but it's the main driver behind the bid in the market."

"So if there's any further

escalation, then \$75 would be the natural level to look at next ahead of \$80."

A Saudi-flagged crude oil tanker was damaged near the Strait of Hormuz — close to the coast of Oman — after a Qatari liquefied natural gas tanker was struck in the same area, maritime security sources said on Tuesday.

A Qatari LNG tanker suffered significant damage after it was hit as it travelled through the Omani side of the strait, four sources with knowledge of the matter said on Tuesday, following reports that Iran's Revolutionary Guards fired missiles at ships transiting through the waterway overnight. Talks to reach a final deal between Tehran and Washington will not take place if US threats continue, Iran's Foreign Minister said on Tuesday, following US President Donald Trump's threat to "finish the job" unless a deal is done.

163.65 lt of fertilizer stocks and rising production can help meet kharif demand, says government

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Against the kharif season's fertilizer demand of 383.9 lakh tonnes (lt) during the April-September period, the country had 163.65 lt in stock as of July 2, equivalent to 43 per cent of the requirement. The government is confident of meeting the demand during the July-September period, backed by higher domestic production.

As of July 2, urea stocks were 69.08 lt, di-ammonium phosphate (DAP) 16.64 lt, muriate of potash (MoP) 8.90 lt, complex (combination of N, P, K nutrients) 45.64 lt and single super phosphate (SSP) 23.09 lt, taking the total stock to 163.35 lt.

The government said domestic urea production in Q1 FY27 (April-June) was 71.55 lt, surpassing the target of 67.86 lt. Similarly, DAP



The government said it ensured uninterrupted fertilizer availability through timely planning

production stood at 9.84 lt and exceeded the target of 8.61 lt. Production of complex was 20.77 lt, while SSP output stood at 13.50 lt, the government said without mentioning their individual targeted outputs.

SUPPLY RESTORED

Natural gas supply to urea plants, which fell to about 65 per cent following disruptions caused by the US-Israel military action against Iran, has now been fully restored

to 100 per cent, enabling all plants to operate at full capacity, officials said.

The fertilizer supply chain has stabilised, with 15 of the 20 vessels carrying imported crop nutrients and raw materials safely transiting the Strait of Hormuz, the Fertilizer Ministry said on July 5.

Of these, eight vessels are carrying 3.32 lt of urea, four are transporting 2.57 lt of DAP, and three are carrying 1.11 lt of Sulphur. All are scheduled to arrive at Indian ports soon.

Further, five more vessels are in the pipeline, including one carrying 0.25 lt of ammonia and 0.45 lt of urea. Loading is also underway for two additional urea vessels and one sulphur vessel, the Ministry said.

The government said it had ensured uninterrupted fertilizer availability through timely planning and monitoring. It also tapped new supply sources through dip-

lomatic outreach, procuring urea from Oman, Malaysia, Vietnam, Georgia, Nigeria, Russia, Finland, Egypt, Algeria, Turkey and the Netherlands.

For DAP and complex, cargoes were routed through the Red Sea route from Russia, Morocco, Egypt, the US, Jordan, South Korea, Tunisia and Saudi Arabia.

Union Fertilizers Minister JP Nadda said in a statement that the West Asia conflict had disrupted global supply chains, driving up fertilizer prices and extending shipment transit times, with India not spared from the fallout. The Ministry said the combination of diversified imports, higher domestic output and adequate stocking had ensured fertilizer availability across the country, and reiterated the government's commitment to safeguarding farmers' interests through timely supply measures.

Monsoon set to cover entire country in 2-3 days as rains shift to the North

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

The 2026 South-West monsoon is on the cusp of completing its annual march across the country, with Rajasthan, Haryana and Punjab next in line before the rain-bearing winds envelop the entire nation over the next two to three days, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said on Tuesday.

The monsoon made significant headway on Tuesday, sweeping across the remaining parts of Gujarat and advancing deeper into Rajasthan and Haryana after breaking out of its brief pause.

Its northern limit now stretches through Barmer, Jodhpur and Rajgarh in Rajasthan before reaching Bathinda in Punjab.

RAIN BELT SHIFTING

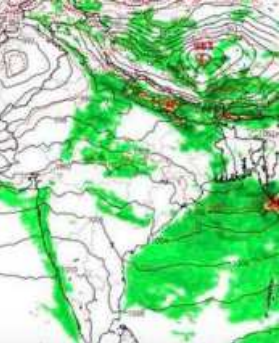
As the monsoon races towards its full coverage, the focus of intense rainfall is shifting east and north. The current belt of heavy to very heavy rain, with isolated extremely heavy falls, is expected to migrate to the hills of West Bengal and Sikkim after unleashing one of the wettest spells of the season over Central and West India.

The widespread downpour has dramatically narrowed India's seasonal rainfall deficit to 20 per cent, bringing it within striking distance of the IMD's 'normal' category.

Central India (-5 per cent), Northwest India (-19 per cent) and the South Peninsula (-15 per cent) have already entered the normal rainfall bracket, while East and North-East India continue to lag with a 41 per cent deficit.

DEPRESSION WEAKENS

The depression that powered the latest rain surge has weakened into a well-marked low-pressure area



Rain will weaken over Central and West India as the heavy rain belt shifts to the Himalayan foothills

and is expected to ease further into a conventional low by Wednesday.

Even in its weakened state, the system is forecast to trigger another round of widespread rain over North-West India before the wet weather shifts towards the Himalayan foothills.

SUPPORT SYSTEMS

The monsoon remains supported by a network of weather systems.

The seasonal trough extends from south-west Rajasthan to Bangladesh, passing through the well-marked low centred over east Madhya Pradesh, north Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand and West Bengal.

A second trough stretches from the north-east Arabian Sea off the Konkan-Mumbai coast across Gujarat to the same low-pressure area before continuing eastward into West Bengal. An offshore trough also persists from south Gujarat to central Kerala. With the rain belt steadily migrating northward, meteorologists will closely watch how long these supporting systems retain their strength and continue to fuel widespread monsoon activity across the country.

They may unravel one after the other as the axis of heavy rainfall shifts towards the farther east-north-east.

Sell aluminium if it rises to ₹345, stop loss at ₹355

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Aluminium futures (₹333/kg) have seen a sharp fall since early June. From the high of ₹397.10 it made on June 3, the price has dropped 16 per cent till now.



COMMODITY CALL.

The chart shows that the downtrend is still valid as there are no signs of a bullish reversal as yet.

However, there is support at ₹327, which has been acting as a good base in the recent sessions.

That said, in case there is a recovery on the back of ₹327, it is unlikely to extend above the ₹345-350 resistance band. So, after rallying to this region, aluminium futures is likely to resume the fall again, potentially dropping to ₹315. On the other hand, if the contract breaks out of

₹350, the outlook could turn positive. In such a case, the price could rise to ₹360 and subsequently move up to ₹370.

But as it stands, the outlook is bearish, and there is a chance for a corrective rally before the next leg of fall.

TRADE STRATEGY

Sell aluminium futures (July) if it rises to ₹345. Place stop-loss at ₹355 and book profits at ₹315.

Instead, if aluminium futures break below the support at ₹327, go short with a stop-loss at ₹335 for a target of ₹315.

Govt urged to look into problems created by fertilizer subsidies

Our Bureau
Chennai

The SOMS (soluble fertilizers, organic and bio-fertilizers, micronutrients and biostimulants) sector has urged the government to look into the problem that subsidies are creating for the entire industry. It has sought an end to dealers' practice of forcing farmers (tagging) to buy other crop nutrients while buying subsidised fertilizers.

Leaders and experts of the sector, who met at a summit in Gandhinagar, Gujarat, on July 1 and 2, focused on strengthening domestic manufacturing capabilities, promoting innovation, reducing dependency on imports and developing sustainable solutions for Indian agricul-

ture. Stakeholders said demand for subsidised fertilizers led to dealers insisting on farmers being forced to buy other crop nutrients which were not required and mooted direct payment as a solution to most of the issues faced by the sector.

\$1 BILLION SECTOR

Rajib Chakraborty, President, Soluble Fertilizers Industry Association (SFIA), said that India's speciality fertilizer sector had huge potential to contribute towards subsidy reduction, sustainable agriculture and nutrition security.

He called for industry-guided research for a self-reliant India (Viksit Bharat). Rahul Mirchandani, President, Indian Micro-Fertilizers Manufacturers Association (IMMA), said the

SOMS sector's market is nearly \$1 billion. Water-soluble fertilizers make up ₹3,700 crore, bio-fertilizers ₹2,350 crore and micro-nutrients ₹2,142 crore.

The sector faces problems due to fertilizer subsidies as dealers force farmers to buy other crop nutrients along with it. "In Rajasthan, farmers have complained that they are forced to buy 10 bottles of nano fertilizers if they want to buy 10 bags of di-ammonium phosphate (a subsidised fertilizer)," he said, adding that this forces them to bear an additional burden of ₹2,400.

Vinod Goyal, National Secretary, SFIA, said the Centre should consider an amendment to Clause 31 of the Essential Commodities Act (ECA) by introducing "unlawful stock".

Why the govt has cut the broken-grain share in PDS rice

bl.explainer

Prabhaddatta Mishra
New Delhi

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) last week approved a new scheme, named Rice Milling Transformation (RMT), under which the share of broken grains in rice supplied from the stock managed by the Food Corporation of India (FCI) has been reduced from the current 25 per cent to 10 per cent in raw (white) rice and from the current 16 per cent to 5 per cent in parboiled rice.

Why was the scheme launched?

The government has a record high 122.64 million tonnes (mt) of foodgrain stock in the Central Pool as of June 1.

It covers 68.34 mt of rice (including 42.84 mt of paddy), 53.41 mt of wheat



The government holds a record 122.64 mt of foodgrains in the Central pool

and 0.9 mt of coarse grains. Some of the grains are lying in the open and need immediate evacuation.

The current scheme will allow the government to transfer the maximum quantity out of 42.84 mt of paddy it has in stock to millers. Besides, the government will not have to lift 15 per cent of broken rice to be

separated during processing, which can translate to saving space for about 4 mt.

The broken rice, though under the government account, will be sold from the premises of rice millers, which will help the government save on transport costs.

How different is it from a similar scheme in Andhra Pradesh under a pilot project?

In Andhra Pradesh, the government ran a pilot scheme, under which broken rice was left with millers. In turn, they were compensated with an incentive of ₹110/quintal, as they were supposed to deposit the same 67 kg of rice containing 10 per cent broken grain from processing 100 kg of paddy, as per norms.

Earlier, 67 kg of rice contained 16.75 kg of broken rice (@25 per cent). After the

launch of the new scheme, millers will deliver 57 kg (including nearly 7 kg of broken grain @10 per cent) to the FCI and retain with them 10 kg, which will be later auctioned by the FCI.

What quantity of rice will be processed under the new quality norms in phase I?

The government has allocated 50 lt of rice under phase I, which includes 37.5 lt of raw rice and 12.5 lt of parboiled rice.

How beneficial will it be for ethanol distilleries?

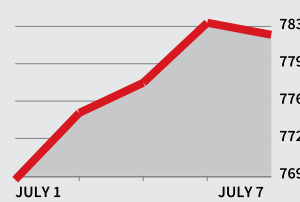
The government has announced the open market sale scheme (OMSS) policy, under which the 15 per cent separated broken rice will be auctioned from rice millers' premises at a base price of ₹20/kg.

This price is lower compared with the separate price of ₹23.20/kg announced for ethanol distilleries. If any distillery ropes in an agent or even directly participates in the auction and is able to get at ₹20-21/kg from any of its nearby rice mills, its cost of production will be lower, and it will be able to sell ethanol at a higher rate.

Oil marketing companies buy ethanol at a higher rate when the biofuel is made out of rice purchased from the open market than from the government's rice-for-ethanol programme.

the hindu businessline

SENSEX 78180.72 (-104.35)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24398.70	-31.65
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	21.22	-0.03
US Dollar (in ₹)	94.96	-0.43
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	143506.00	-1494
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	227200.00	-5958

GREEN DRIVE.

If India wants higher ethanol blending, it needs a clear roadmap for older cars, says Mercedes-Benz India MD Santosh Iyer **p7**



DATA FOCUS.

Delhi, West Bengal and Tamil Nadu see decline in State GST collections in Q1 FY27 **p2**

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QUICKLY.

BETTING BIG
UP Data Centre Policy sends strong signal to market



New Delhi: The Uttar Pradesh Data Centre Policy 2026's focus on AI-ready capacity, graphics processing unit infrastructure, sustainability and regional development sends a strong signal to the market and will help unlock the next wave of investments, analysts said. A meeting of the UP Cabinet, chaired by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on Monday, cleared the policy. **p9**

RISING IMPORTS
China's share of auto parts supply up in FY26

New Delhi: Even though there was a robust growth in the Indian auto components sector in FY26, imports from China were still higher at 36 per cent during the year compared with 29 per cent in FY25, a performance review for FY26 shared by the Automotive Component Manufacturers Association of India has indicated. **p2**

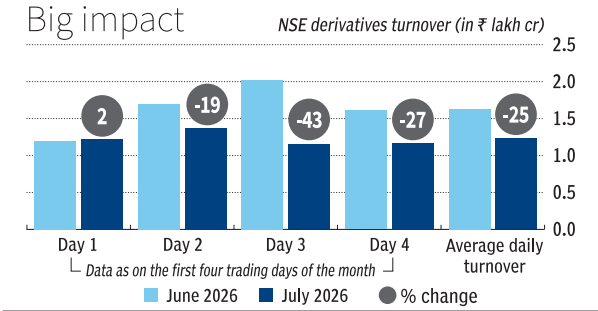
RBI lending restrictions dent proprietary derivatives trading

TAKING A BEATING. Average daily turnover drops 25% on NSE and 30% on BSE since July 1

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

The RBI's move to tighten bank lending for proprietary trading in the equity derivatives market from July has become evident in the sharp decline in trading turnover over the last four trading sessions. The average daily turnover (ADT) in the derivatives segment on the NSE during the last four trading sessions fell 25 per cent to ₹1,22,677 crore compared with ₹1,63,328 crore recorded during the corresponding period last month.

FUTURES & OPTIONS
The ADT in stock and index futures on the NSE declined 4 per cent and 49 per cent, respectively, to ₹69,524 crore and ₹11,420 crore, against ₹72,223 crore and ₹22,506 crore registered during the same period in June. Similarly, the premium ADT in index and stock options during the last four trading sessions dropped 45 per cent and 17 per cent to ₹34,038 crore and ₹7,694 crore, respectively, from



Source: NSE

₹62,017 crore and ₹6,581 crore in the corresponding period, according to the exchange data. A similar trend was seen on the BSE, where the ADT in futures and options during the last four trading sessions fell 30 per cent to ₹27,255 crore from ₹38,881 crore. Ketan Marwadi, Member, Capital Market Participants Association of India, said that ever since the revised norms came into effect, the industry's concerns extended beyond the immediate liquidity impact involving more than ₹50,000 crore. "If a distinction is not made between speculative and directional proprietary trades, domestic intermedi-

aries could be forced to create room for foreign proprietary firms to capture a larger share of market volumes and profitability. This could eventually lead to a gradual shift of value creation, tax revenue and employment opportunities from India," Marwadi said. Anand James, Chief Market Strategist at Geojit Investments, said derivatives trading volumes, particularly in futures where capital requirements are higher, are likely to remain under pressure in the near term and could moderate further as firms adjust to the new regulatory framework. "Impact costs will also be affected as bid-ask spreads

widen. While this may not significantly hurt investor profitability, high-frequency traders who rely on thin margins and high liquidity could face challenges," he added.

MARGIN FUNDING
Sachin Gupta, Vice-President (Research) at Choice Equity Broking, said futures trading inherently depends on margin funding and as funding costs rise, many traders are likely to scale back their activity, with larger institutional participants becoming more cautious. Feroze Azeez, Joint CEO of Anand Rathii Wealth, noted that proprietary firms account for a meaningful share of the derivatives market liquidity, particularly in options and arbitrage strategies. As firms adjust their funding structures and deploy a larger proportion of their own capital, participation is expected to become more selective. Amid the fall in derivatives trading activity, shares of the BSE and MCX came under pressure, falling 3 per cent each to ₹3,679 and ₹2,643, respectively, on Tuesday.

Indonesia inks deal to buy India's BrahMos, Astra missiles

Dalip Singh
New Delhi



DEFENCE TIES. Indonesia is the third potential foreign buyer of the BrahMos cruise missile after Vietnam and the Philippines

India's missile diplomacy gathered pace as Indonesia signed initial agreements to purchase BrahMos supersonic missiles and Astra beyond-visual-range air-to-air missiles during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's Jakarta visit on Tuesday. Both missiles were successfully deployed by India to target Pakistani defence installations and terror infrastructure in the four-day long Operation Sindoor. The two deals show intent and in-principle agreement to buy the battle-proven missiles, people aware of the developments said. A joint statement issued by the two countries said that both Modi and Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto "welcomed the elevation of defence cooperation, including on BrahMos missile system, and the air-to-air missile co-operation agreement". Sources said Indonesia had agreed to buy two batteries of BrahMos missiles, which is one more than what it previously wanted and discussed during the initial iterations with the Indian

government for more than three years. A battery of BrahMos includes missiles, launchers, command post, radar and tracking systems. As per the announcements in Jakarta, BrahMos Aerospace, a JV between the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and Russia's NPO Mashinostroyeniya, and Indonesia's Defence Ministry signed the contract to take the BrahMos negotiations forward. **ASTRA MISSILES** Similarly, Indonesia's private defence company Republicorp and India's state-owned Bharat Dynamics Ltd signed an agreement for the Astra missiles. The quantities and the

value would be decided subsequently, said sources. Details of the contract for both the missiles will now be worked on by the two countries. Indonesia is emerging as the third potential foreign buyer of the BrahMos cruise missile after Vietnam and the Philippines, which have already inked deals, signalling that the missile is no longer a one-off export but is beginning to establish itself in the international market. It is also the first country to acquire the Astra beyond-visual-range air-to-air missile, giving India its first export breakthrough for another indigenous missile system. The deal strengthens India's ambition to become a major defence exporter.

MUDSLIDE HITS WAYANAD



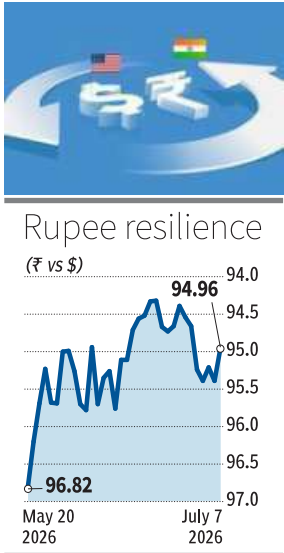
RAIN FURY. A bus stuck in debris after a mudslide at Kalladi, near the Meppadi tunnel project in Wayanad, Kerala, on Tuesday. Speaking to reporters after visiting the site near Meenakshi Bridge, where work on the tunnel project is underway, North Zone DIG K Karthick said three bodies had been recovered, while several others were injured in the disaster following extreme rainfall. Search is on for 5 persons. The Met Dept has issued a red alert for Wayanad and Kozhikode districts **(Report on page 9)** **p11**

Rupee logs biggest single-day gain in 3 weeks, closes below 95/dollar mark

K Ram Kumar
Mumbai

The rupee on Tuesday logged its biggest single day gain in over three weeks, buoyed by RBI intervention and dollar sales by exporters. The Indian unit closed 44 paise stronger at 94.96 per US dollar against the previous close of 95.40. Intraday, the rupee tested a high/low of 94.94/95.37. V Rama Chandra Reddy, Head of Treasury, Karur Vysya Bank, said there was talk in the market of central bank intervention (sale of dollars) through public sector banks.

STRONG RECOVERY
Pressure on the domestic currency eased as crude oil prices are relatively subdued and foreign portfolio investors (FPI) are gradually



coming back into the Indian market, eyeing investments in IPOs, he said. Amit Pabari, MD, CR Forex Advisors, observed that the rupee staged a

strong recovery on Tuesday, appreciating sharply from Monday's three-week low to close at 94.96, its strongest level in about a week, as supportive domestic factors outweighed external headwinds. The primary driver behind Tuesday's move was the continued decline in crude oil prices. **FALLING CRUDE OIL** Brent crude remained near \$72 per barrel, its lowest level in more than four months, after OPEC+ agreed to increase production once again, and Saudi Aramco cut the official selling price of its Arab Light for Asian buyers, he said. Pabari underscored that for an oil-importing economy like India, lower crude prices reduce the country's import bill and ease the demand for dollars, providing direct support to the rupee.

The currency also benefited from improving foreign portfolio flows. **FPIs TURN NET BUYERS** FPIs turned net buyers of Indian financial stocks in the second half of June, investing ₹14,634 crore after being net sellers earlier in the month. "These inflows, driven by global index rebalancing and value buying, boosted dollar supplies in the domestic market," Pabari said. "At the same time, the global dollar remained broadly range-bound, allowing domestic positives to have a greater influence on the rupee's performance," he added. He assessed that despite Tuesday's sharp appreciation, the move could be viewed more as a corrective pullback rather than the start of a sustained strengthening trend.

Delhi, Jakarta sign pacts on health, key minerals

Press Trust of India
Jakarta

India and Indonesia signed agreements in health, education and other sectors on Tuesday, including one on establishing an overseas campus of the Indian Institute of Management (IIM)-Bangalore, Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced here.

IIM CAMPUS
Modi landed in Jakarta on Monday to a red-carpet welcome in the first leg of his three-nation tour, which will also cover Australia and New Zealand, to strengthen trade and security co-operation. "We are going to establish an overseas campus of the prestigious Indian Institute of Management-Bangalore in Indonesia. This will greatly benefit young people across the Asean region," Modi said, while delivering a joint press statement with Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto.



HIGHEST HONOUR. PM Narendra Modi was conferred Indonesia's highest honour, the Bintang Adipurna, by President Prabowo Subianto for strengthening bilateral ties **p11**

The IIM e-campus will be set up at the Singhasari Special Economic Zone in Indonesia's East Java province. IIM-Ahmedabad was the first premier Indian business school to open a campus outside India. It was launched in Dubai last year. In the health sector, India's Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation and Indonesia's National Agency of Drug and Food Control signed a memorandum of

understanding to co-operate in medical products regulation, enabling knowledge exchange on global regulatory standards and enhancing market access for Indian medical products in Indonesia. India and Indonesia also agreed to jointly develop the strategically-located Sabang Port, which overlooks the Strait of Malacca and is 100 km from India's Great Nicobar Port Project.

In another significant move, New Delhi decided to invest in the manufacture of steel, nickel and rare earth permanent magnets in Indonesia. "In today's world, supply chain resilience in technology has become critically important. We have also concluded an important agreement to strengthen supply chain resilience in the areas of critical minerals and steel," Modi said. **UPI EXTENSION** The Prime Minister said India's Unified Payments Interface will soon be integrated with Indonesia's payment system and it will further enhance both the ease of doing business and travel between the countries. The two sides also decided to enhance co-operation in the areas of blue economy, maritime trade and port development. They also decided to boost co-operation in the space sector.

Inadequate storage of solar power causing grid stress, says study by PM-EAC

M Ramesh
Chennai



A working paper (study) by the Prime Minister's Economic Advisory Council (PM-EAC) has highlighted a nagging issue in the solar power industry — as solar power is meeting more and more of midday demand, it is forcing conventional power plants, such as thermal, to ramp up and down more sharply to meet the net load. The paper blames slow adoption of battery storage for this. "Battery storage is the most direct solution," the paper notes, adding that while pumped hydro storage has nearly achieved its planned capacity, battery deployment remains well below national targets. This has made India's storage deficit "primarily a battery shortfall". The re-

power system from generation capacity to grid flexibility, requiring a major scale-up of battery storage, demand response and time-of-day tariffs. "The defining problem of the grid is no longer how much electricity the country can generate, but when it can generate it and how fast it can change what it generates," the authors wrote in the paper. "The binding constraint has shifted from capacity to flexibility." **THREE INDICATORS** The authors cite three clear indicators of the emerging problem: A widening gap between electricity prices during solar and non-solar hours, most instances of unmet demand occurring after sunset, and increasing curtailment of solar generation because it cannot be absorbed by the grid when pro-

duced. They estimate that, on an average day in May, curtailed solar energy was enough to power more than a quarter of Delhi for an entire day. The study estimated that halving the evening ramp in electricity demand would require around 130 GWh of storage discharge over a seven-hour period, whereas the country's pumped-storage and battery fleet currently discharges only about 24 GWh a day on average. This, it said, shows that existing storage is useful "at the margin" but far from sufficient to reshape the country's daily load curve. The authors welcomed recent policy initiatives, including the proposed amendments to electricity laws that promote demand response, time-of-day tariffs, energy storage and stronger renewable purchase obligations.

QUICKLY.

NFRA begins probe into Rajesh Exports



Mumbai: The National Financial Reporting Authority (NFRA) began a probe into Rajesh Exports for alleged financial misstatement and revenue appreciation, Nitin Gupta, NFRA Chairman, said on Tuesday at FICCI's National Conference on Agile governance. **OUR BUREAU**

Hitachi Energy, TN govt sign MoU for expansion

Chennai: Hitachi Energy, the Switzerland-based subsidiary of Hitachi Group, has signed an MoU with the Department of Industries, Investment Promotion and Commerce, Government of Tamil Nadu, to expand its facilities in the State. Under the MoU, Hitachi will invest ₹1,000 crore for the expansion of its Global Technology and Innovation Centre in Chennai and its manufacturing facility in Chengalpattu over the next three-five years. **OUR BUREAU**

China’s share of auto component supply to India rose 36% in FY26

DOMESTIC GROWTH. Sector saw ₹7.6 lakh cr turnover in FY26, up 12.7% year-on-year

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Even though there is a robust growth in the Indian auto components sector in FY26, imports from China are still higher at 36 per cent during the year compared with 29 per cent in FY25, the performance review for FY26 shared by the Automotive Component Manufacturers Association of India (ACMA) has indicated.

According to the Industry Performance Review for FY26, ACMA said while the US remains the key destination for exports at 26 per cent in FY26, China is the key source of imports with 36 per cent, followed by Japan (11 per cent), Germany (10 per cent) and South Korea (7 per cent).

LARGEST SOURCE

“The auto industry is a global industry and no one country makes everything... We don’t have an OEM (original equipment manufacturer) from China though, but the OEMs from China are now selling finished products in



BRIGHT PROSPECTS. With continued domestic demand and exports despite geopolitical headwinds, the auto components sector in India is expected to grow 8-10 per cent in FY27 **BUJOY GHOSH**

India. Yet there is a significant import of auto components from China, and the reason for imports from China, or any place could be manifold,” Vinnie Mehta, Director General, ACMA, told *businessline*. Mehta said there could be various reasons, such as technology-related ones, as some vehicle manufacturing companies are global and require critical components that are not yet made in India. Secondly, it could be that some companies have a policy to import from a Mother plant of a particular

item for production in a particular geography, and that geography is China. And thirdly, it could be a very simple, price-competitive reason. “Another reason could be, when in the domestic capacities growth happens in the vehicle industry a little too fast and there could be a capacity shortfall, they may resort to import from China. At least in one particular case where China sort of stopped export of rare earth magnets, but it has not stopped import of sub-assemblies and exported with fitted rare earth magnets or finished product

from there,” Mehta explained.

OUTLOOK POSITIVE

Meanwhile, driven by robust domestic demand, higher vehicle production and sustained investments in capacity, the Indian auto components sector recorded a turnover of ₹7.60 lakh crore (\$85.9 billion) in FY26, registering a 12.7 per cent growth.

With continued domestic demand and exports, despite geopolitical headwinds, the sector is expected to grow 8-10 per cent in the current fiscal, it said. “The medium-to-long-term outlook for the Indian auto component industry remains positive. Growing domestic demand, infrastructure-led economic growth, expanding manufacturing investments, deeper global integration through Free Trade Agreements (FTAs) and increasing global sourcing from India are creating significant opportunities for the sector,” Vikram-pati Singhania, President, ACMA and Vice-Chairman and MD, JK Fenner (India), said.

EV registrations race to an all-time high in June, surge 63 per cent to 3.06 lakh units: FADA

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

June 2026 was a defining month in India’s mobility transition with the industry retailing 3,06,220 electric vehicles (EVs) — an all-time high — and nearly 63 per cent higher than 1,88,058 units in the corresponding month last year, the Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations (FADA), said on Tuesday.

“June 2026 was an all-time high in FADA’s records and nearly 63 per cent higher than a year ago — even as the broader market navigated a delayed monsoon and a seasonally-lean patch. What makes this transition durable is its breadth and ownership. Legacy manufacturers now lead the electric two-wheeler space, established players are scaling electric cars and commercial



LEADING THE PACK. In the ePV segment, Tata Motors continued to lead the market, retailing 12,187 units **REUTERS**

vehicles, and new entrants — both Indian and global — are choosing India as a priority market,” CS Vigneshwar, President, FADA, said.

SALES GROWTH

Encouragingly, this was not a single-category story, he said, adding that electric pas-

senger vehicles (ePVs) at 31,823 units and electric commercial vehicles (eCVs) at 3,214 units delivered their best-ever months, while electric two-wheelers (e2Ws) held strong at 1,93,735 units, and electric three-wheelers (e3Ws) reached 77,448 units.

The ePVs retail sales grew 108 per cent year-on-year from 15,318 units in June last year, while e2Ws sales grew 75 per cent from 1,10,719 units). Similarly, eCVs sales grew 164 per cent from 1,219 units and e3Ws grew 27.38 per cent from 60,802 units in June 2025, the FADA retail data indicated.

EPV SEGMENT

In the ePV segment, Tata Motors continued to lead the market retailing 12,187 units (5,375 units), followed by Mahindra & Mahindra at 7,766 units (3,513 units) and JSW MG Motor India at 5,861 units (4,691 units). In the e2W segment, TVS Motor led the market with registration of 47,064 units (26,734 units), followed by Bajaj Auto at 43,306 units (23,987), Ather Energy at 31,230 units (16,015 units) and Hero MotoCorp (Vida)

at 21,820 units (7,920 units). Once the market leader, Ola Electric has slipped to fifth place with sales of 16,150 units in June (20,697 units).

EV PENETRATION

“With overall EV penetration crossing 12 per cent for the first time — led by three-wheelers, where over 64 per cent of retail is now electric, and two-wheelers, now in double-digits at 10.6 per cent — electrification has moved decisively from the margins to the mainstream of Indian auto retail,” Vigneshwar said.

This is the India growth story expressing itself in clean, self-reliant mobility: Rising aspiration, widening affordability and a customer increasingly ready to go electric wherever the product, the charging ecosystem and the economics come together, he added.

Delhi, West Bengal and Tamil Nadu see decline in SGST collections in Q1 FY27

Sourashis Banerjee
Deepak Nishanth
Chennai

The first quarter of the new fiscal year of 2026-27, after the implementation of GST 2.0 in September 2025, presented a mixed picture for State Goods and Services Tax (SGST) collections across India.

DATA FOCUS.

Nationwide SGST collections growth slowed to 3.4 per cent year-on-year during April-June of 2026 (Q1 FY27), from 8.9 per cent a year earlier and 10.7 per cent in the corresponding quarter of FY25. The moderation was accompanied by significant divergence among States, with five major States, including consumption powerhouses like Delhi and Tamil Nadu, reporting a decline in SGST collections even as several others posted double-digit growth, indicating that the impact of the new GST regime has varied across regional economies.

SGST DECLINE

Delhi recorded the steepest contraction in SGST collections among the 20 largest States by GST collections, with collections declining 11.9 per cent year-on-year in the first quarter of FY27. This marked a sharp reversal from growth of 24.4 per cent in the same period a year ago. Tamil Nadu and West Bengal also entered negative territory, with collections falling 2.8 per cent and 2 per cent, respectively.

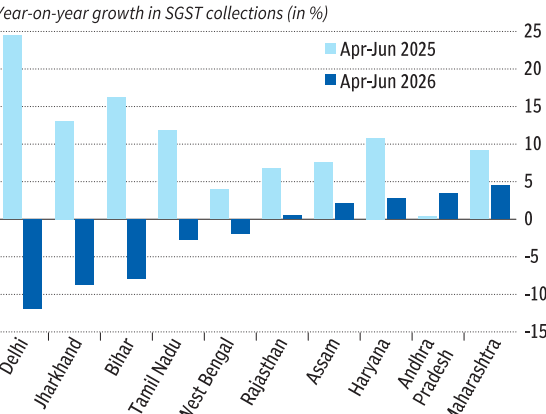
According to Manoj Mishra, Partner at Grant Thornton Bharat, “GST 2.0 rate rationalisation has reduced the tax incidence on several consumption-oriented sectors, and States with greater exposure to such sectors are likely to see a temporary moderation in own SGST collections despite stable transaction volumes.”

Delhi, among the bigger consumers of automobiles and white goods, which underwent a significant reduction in large GST rates could have witnessed a reduction in collections as a result.

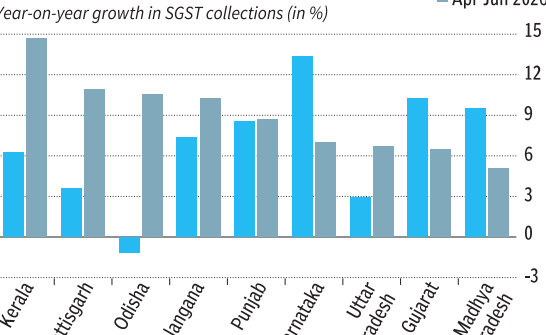
The ‘White Paper on the Fiscal Management of Tamil Nadu’ brought out by the new government, points towards inefficient tax collection as one of the major reasons for the de-growth in SGST collections in the

SGST collections in Q1 of FY27

Delhi saw the maximum de-growth in SGST collections, in first quarter of the new fiscal, following GST 2.0

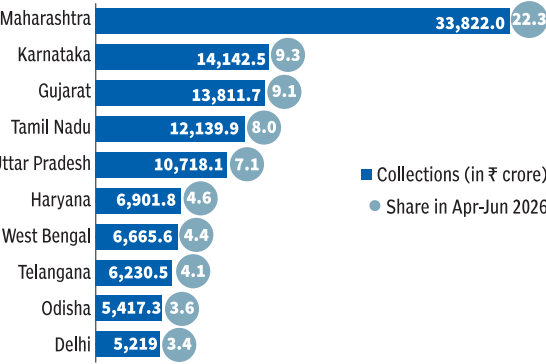


Kerala & Chhattisgarh lead the pack in growth in SGST collections



Share of contribution from large States mostly stable

The total SGST collections by the bigger States (in %)



Source: GST portal

State. Traditionally, lower-consumption States like Jharkhand saw an 8.7 per cent decline after recording 13.1 per cent growth in Q1 FY26, while Bihar slipped 7.9 per cent compared (16.2 per cent growth).

POSITIVE GROWTH

At the other end of the spectrum, Kerala recorded the fastest SGST growth among the States covered, with collections rising 14.7 per cent year-on-year during the quarter (6.3 per cent). Chhattisgarh followed with 10.9 per cent growth, while Odisha rebounded strongly to 10.6 per cent after recording a marginal contraction last year. Telangana also

crossed the double-digit mark with 10.2 per cent growth. “Stronger growth in Karnataka, Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh, Kerala and Telangana suggests that sectoral composition, manufacturing and services activity, and compliance levels are also influencing revenue outcomes,” explained Mishra. However, experts also point towards the high inflation in Kerala as it may have artificially inflated tax collection figures. Additionally, improved GST governance and enforcement efforts have contributed to the up-tick in revenue receipts.

Deepak Nishanth is an intern

‘Exports a key growth driver for Data Patterns’

Our Bureau
Chennai

Defence and aerospace solutions provider Data Patterns is bullish on exports and has flagged the growing acceptance of its solutions and capabilities in the international markets in FY26.

In his message to shareholders, S Rangarajan, Chairman and Managing Director (promoter) of Data Patterns, said the company’s products consistently met global standards, and they are increasingly seeing customer interest outside India.

“The successful development, export and acceptance of the transportable precision approach radar by a European customer repres-

ents an important milestone in this journey,” he said.

“Our export business continued to make steady progress in FY26, with an export order-book of approximately ₹53 crore as on date. We continue to execute repeat business from the UK, while actively engaging with customers across Europe and other international markets,” he added.

GROWTH STRATEGY

Rangarajan believes that exports will become an important pillar of its long-term growth strategy. “As countries increase defence spending, modernise their armed forces and diversify supply chains, Indian defence companies are gaining greater visibility and accept-

The company is optimistic about India’s push for defence self-reliance and says it has increased defence spending and created growth opportunities for indigenous defence technology firms

ance,” he said.

FY26 was a strong year for Data Patterns, which saw revenue grow 31 per cent year-on-year to ₹925 crore, while EBITDA increased 35 per cent to ₹371 crore.

“Our electronic warfare suites, including self-protection jammer pods for Indian fighter aircraft, have received encouraging feedback and are progressing towards the next stages of testing,” he added.

PORTFOLIO EXPANSION

“We are also expanding our portfolio in airborne surveillance radars, maritime applications, drone detection and counter-drone technologies, electronic support systems and advanced surveillance solutions.”

The company is optimistic about India’s push for defence self-reliance and says it has increased defence spending and created growth opportunities for indigenous defence technology firms.

Allcargo Logistics sees AI-enabled, integrated solutions driving market share gains

bl.interview

G Naga Sridhar
Hyderabad

Allcargo Logistics, which focuses exclusively on the domestic market after its restructuring, is sharpening investments in AI-enabled operations, digital platforms and customer-centric logistics solutions.

The company, which serves over 19,000 pin codes through its Express and Contract Logistics businesses, expects to outpace industry growth while expanding its technology footprint. Ketan Kulkarni, MD & CEO, Allcargo Logistics, speaks on

the industry scenario and business plans.

Edited excerpts:

Has the West Asia conflict affected your business?

The immediate impact has been fuel price volatility, particularly on the Express business. However, diesel price revisions are passed through a transparent industry-wide pricing mechanism.

On the Contract Logistics side, some customers experienced supply-side disruptions, but our AI-driven predictive analytics and close customer engagement helped minimise operational impact. Our domestic business has remained resilient

We are preparing to launch a prepaid digital wallet for retail customers and MSMEs with loyalty rewards and cashback benefits

KETAN KULKARNI
MD & CEO, Allcargo Logistics



despite the geopolitical uncertainty.

Where do you see the biggest growth opportunities over the next two-three years? Growth will come from two fronts — India’s improving

macroeconomic environment and increasing customer demand for integrated logistics solutions. Policy measures such as the National Logistics Policy, GST and Dedicated Freight Corridors have significantly improved the operating en-

vironment. Our focus is now on strengthening both physical and digital infrastructure. We already cover more than 19,000 pincodes through 650 operating facilities.

How is tech changing your business model?

Technology has become as important as physical infrastructure.

Customers can now book shipments through a unified digital platform integrated with warehouse management, transport management and route optimisation systems. A 24x7 monitoring centre tracks shipments across the first, middle and last mile. AI is increasingly being deployed for predict-

ive analytics, automated customer support, intelligent email routing, quotation management and delivery quality monitoring. We are also preparing to launch a prepaid digital wallet for retail customers and MSMEs with loyalty rewards and cashback benefits.

Competition remains intense, especially in Express logistics. What differentiates Allcargo?

Contract logistics is already a highly-organised business requiring significant investments in Grade-A warehouses and technology. In Express logistics, while the unorganised segment remains sizeable, tighter regulatory compliance is steadily

shifting business towards organised players. Our strength in contract logistics lies in designing customised supply-chain solutions for customers.

In Express, our competitive advantage comes from nationwide reach, faster transit times, technology-led visibility and competitive pricing.

What are the biggest trends shaping the logistics industry?

Automation and artificial intelligence will define the industry’s next growth phase. Labour shortages are accelerating investments in robotics, warehouse automation and automated material handling systems.

Tata Power to set up solar factory in Odisha

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

Tata Power will announce a solar manufacturing project in Odisha in the coming months as it steps up investments across the clean energy value chain, Chairman N Chandrasekaran said at its annual general meeting on Tuesday. The company has crossed 26 GW of generation capacity, including projects under development; currently, 66 per cent of its portfolio is clean and green.

During FY26, it commissioned around 2.5 GW of renewable energy projects and has another 5.1 GW under execution. It is also expanding its energy storage portfolio through the 1,000-MW Bhivpuri and 1,800-MW Shirwata pumped storage projects. Tata Power’s 4.3-GW solar cell and module manufacturing facility in Tirunelveli has completed its first full year of operations, while the rooftop solar business added around 2 GW during the year, taking cumulative installations to over 4 GW across over three lakh consumers, Chandrasekaran told shareholders.

businessline.

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Perils of digital ‘lockout’

Bank branches must help out harried customers

PT Jyothi Datta

All of a sudden, the benefit of a name like Elon Musk’s son “X” — without the accompanying alpha-numerics — becomes tangible. Almost aspirational.

With a name like that, you could breeze through “kyc” (know your customer) drills that institutions private and otherwise require from you, repeatedly. There is no worry of your name being spelt differently from the way your parents may have intended to call you.

Sometimes, it almost feels like there is a resistance movement at different institutions, as their representatives spell your name in the manner they are familiar with, in line with the region they hail from.

So, if they are from Southern India, your name has a “h”, and if they are from the northern regions, the “h” is axed in your name — observations from personal experience.

But the horror of it all comes alive when you have to digitally link all the government, private, identity and other details. That’s when the humble “h” can play havoc (with a capital “H”) — leading to anxiety-producing outcomes that can render 50-plus years of your existence as, well non-existent.

Or, it can lock you out of your online account at the big beautiful bank that you have been with for close to three decades, two cities and multiple relationship managers.

DIGITAL STRANGLEHOLD
Recounting a “lived experience” here — no amount of documentation can rescue you when you are digitally locked out. Not even bank managers, it seems, can make a dogmatic digital system heel.

Biometrics, is suggested, to bypass digital dogma.

But that too has pitfalls — who owns the data, has access to it, and how fool-proof is the system? More fundamentally, why should a citizen provide biometric information at a private institution to prove identity? And in this case, for no fault on the customer’s part?

Back to seeking answers on why the digital gateway locked a “privileged” (designated by the bank), white-haired, tax-paying customer out of her account of more than 20 years?

Multiple reasons are extended by bank representatives, seemingly just as dumbstruck by



DIGITAL DEADLOCK. Causing anxiety /ISTOCKPHOTO

the stubborn digital system. Maybe the spelling difference between multiple government cards (again, no fault of the customer)? Checked, addressed.

Still no show. Maybe different addresses — account opened in a different city — a digital realisation not picked up last KYC? Now more documents are called for - to prove you’ve walked the streets of Mumbai for several years now.

Finally, the *Eureka* moment. A helpful bank representative explains — possibly, the digital system reads three components in a name.

UNWIELDY NAMES
Heaven help you, if your parents let their regional pride spill into your name to make it long, unwieldy and with three components — exacerbated by marriage that adds a fourth component. Oh! for the joy of having a name like X.

But seriously, making a bank account digitally inaccessible to a customer because the bank’s system falls short — is a violation of a customer’s financial rights. Financial institutions should have fool-proof methods available at local branches to resolve a digital deadlock — where the head of a branch, for example, can check the customer’s Cibil score, record and defaults (or absence of it), and help the customer.

This can be done with checks, counter-checks, and speed — if institutions put resources behind helping customers, rather than merely seeing them as targets to sell financial products.

A banking ombudsman is useful. But a locally accessible person and a water-tight, yet simple approach is needed for customers.

Otherwise, the digital “*chakravayuh*” (maze) ends up trapping honest customers, while crooked ones seemingly trapeze through it.



RICHA MISHRA

Under its 2026 chairship, India hosted the 11th BRICS Energy Ministers’ Meeting last month, focusing on the theme ‘Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability’ where the BRICS Energy Ministers reaffirmed the importance of respecting national circumstances, development priorities and energy pathways.

As is the case in all such meetings, it concluded with the adoption of the Joint Communiqué, reflecting the collective vision and consensus of BRICS countries. A major outcome of India’s Chairship was the launch of the BRICS Digital Centre of Excellence for Smart Grids and Energy Storage.

The entire meeting was guided by the Energy Track theme ‘Energy for All’ and was split into three priority areas:

Energy Security and Sustainability — focusing on resilient energy systems, diversified energy sources, critical minerals, supply chain resilience, grid modernisation, energy storage, and secure, affordable energy supplies.

Energy Access and Equity — focusing on universal access to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern energy, clean cooking solutions, affordable financing, capacity building, and support for emerging markets and developing economies.

Technology and Innovation — focusing on smart grids, energy storage, hydrogen value chains, digitalisation of energy systems, artificial intelligence, energy efficiency, biofuels, carbon capture technologies, and strengthening research and innovation cooperation across BRICS countries.

DIPLOMATIC EDGE
Now, translating these ideas from paper to reality will challenge any country’s diplomatic agility.

However, the expanded BRICS+ landscape gives New Delhi a distinct edge by bringing energy powerhouses such as Russia, Saudi Arabia, the UAE, and Iran under one umbrella. By negotiating long-term contracts and deep discounts on hydrocarbons, India can build a resilient firewall against global price shocks and geopolitical turbulence.



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

India must use the expanded BRICS+ group, with Saudi Arabia, Iran and the UAE, to curb China’s green tech domination

Addressing the Ministerial Meeting, Union Minister of Power Manohar Lal had highlighted that energy remains fundamental to economic growth, social progress and human development and emphasised that developing countries require adequate time, resources and policy space to pursue sustainable development while meeting the aspirations of their people. He underlined India’s commitment to building resilient, future-ready and people-centric energy systems guided by

With India’s green energy ambitions and China being a major supplier of green energy components, keeping the trade deficit under check will be a major challenge

the principle of ‘Energy for All’.

India’s energy transformation over the last decade is not unnoticed. The country has emerged as the world’s third-largest producer and consumer of electricity, with installed power capacity reaching nearly 540 GW and non-fossil sources accounting for more than half of the installed capacity. India’s rapid clean energy expansion, with solar capacity increasing from about 3 GW in 2014 to more than 154 GW today, underscores the role of New Delhi’s flagship initiatives.

The Minister, at the meet, highlighted India’s ambitions to achieve over 400 GWh of energy storage capacity by 2032 and 100 GW of nuclear power capacity by 2047, alongside its achievement of 20 per cent ethanol blending ahead of schedule and leadership in initiatives such as the Global Biofuels Alliance and the International Solar Alliance.

The BRICS Ministers also appreciated

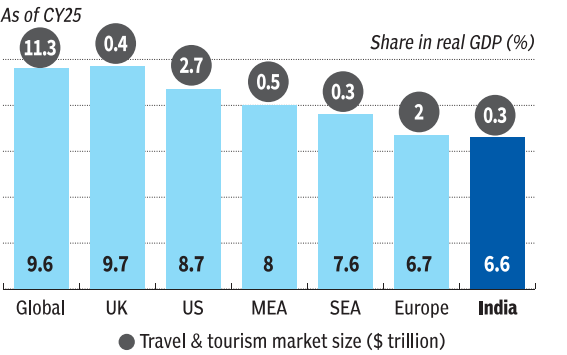
STATISTALK.

Compiled by **Hema Varshni S**, intern | Graphic **KS Gunasekar**

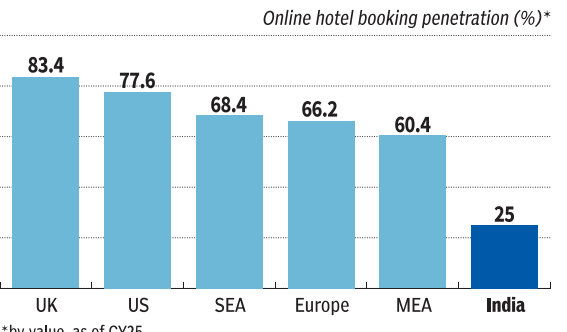
India’s fragmented hotel market: An untapped opportunity

While developed Western markets are highly organised and digitally mature, India represents a massive, untapped frontier in global hospitality. According to OYO’s recently filed DRHP, the country records a large volume of occupied room nights, demonstrating robust travel demand. However, India’s lodging ecosystem operates largely offline. The nation’s low 25 per cent online booking penetration is attributable to a highly unorganised and fragmented supply side — hotels from the unorganised space account for 92 per cent, highlighting the growth headroom for organised players

India’s tourism GDP share - lower than global average



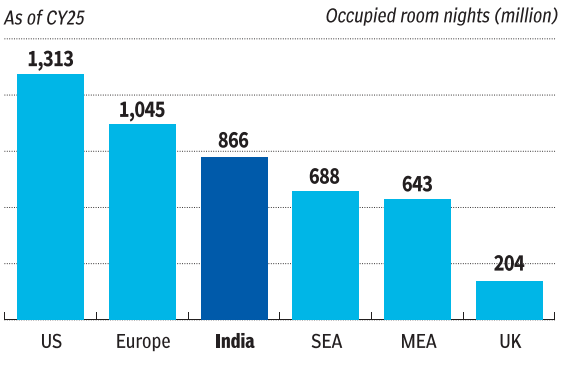
Only one in four hotel bookings in India are online



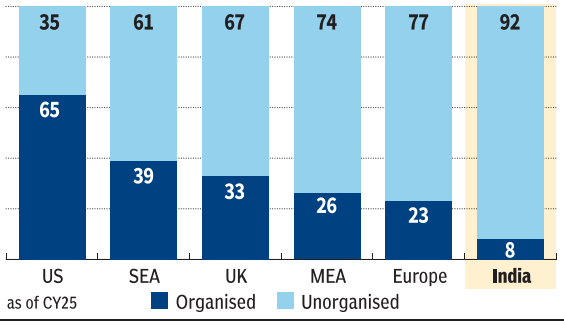
Source: Oravel Stays (OYO) DRHP

MEA - Middle East & Africa, SEA - Southeast Asia

India ranks higher on occupied room nights



India’s hotel industry remains predominantly unorganised



the ongoing efforts in finalisation of the BRICS Joint Report on Hydrogen Value Chains 2026, which provides a foundation for enhanced cooperation on hydrogen technologies, standards, industrial applications and future value chains.

The Joint Communiqué reaffirmed that energy security remains a cornerstone of BRICS cooperation. The Ministers underscored the importance of balanced and diversified energy mixes, promotion of cleaner and more efficient energy technologies, and cooperation in areas such as new technologies in fossil fuels, renewable energy, biofuels, hydrogen, energy storage, critical minerals, carbon capture technologies, digitalisation and energy efficiency while reaffirming the importance of affordable financing.

The Ministers also reaffirmed their commitment to deepening collaboration in support of secure, affordable, sustainable and resilient energy systems and looked forward to continuing cooperation under the Chairship of the People’s Republic of China in 2027.

THE CHALLENGES AHEAD

As India gets ambitious about its green energy transition, and China globally is a major supplier, to what extent will the two be able to create a trade balance? What few are talking about is a concept of co-trade and joint purchasing power within an expanded BRICS+ framework present India with a unique strategic mechanism to protect its economic interests, stabilise volatile energy costs, and limit China’s regional hegemony.

With BRICS generating over half of the world’s solar power, India must pivot the forum’s agenda away from installation targets and toward supply chain resilience. This structural shift is vital to stop China from leveraging the platform to cement its monopoly on upstream manufacturing components.

India can counter Chinese dominance by anchoring BRICS transnational grid initiatives to the International Solar Alliance. Championing ISA-approved standards and open-source protocols establishes a systemic defence against proprietary Chinese energy networks across the Global South.

Yet, transforming this strategy into reality will severely test India’s diplomatic agility. Since China serves as the primary green-tech supplier to India and the rest of the world, New Delhi will need to deploy highly sophisticated statecraft to alter these entrenched trade dynamics.

On businessline.in

VB-G RAM G: Reading the fine print

The scheme represents less a strengthening of India’s rural jobs guarantee than a restructuring of who bears its cost and who controls its design, says **Dhananjay Sinha**



<https://tinyurl.com/3fmds28t>

The carbohydrate nation

India is becoming the diabetes capital of the world before it becomes rich. The thali needs rebalancing, avers **Aditya Sinha**



<https://tinyurl.com/duwfn8cv>

Labour markets need state intervention

A freely functioning labour market is a fallacy. State intervention and institutional support are essential for inclusive growth, argue **Trishna Sarkar** and **C Saratchand**



<https://tinyurl.com/5n7n8kn6>

thehindubusinessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

July 8, 2006

Mittal to set up plant in Orissa

The Arcelor-Mittal Chief, Mr Lakshmi Niwas Mittal, announced here on Friday that his next destination was Orissa and his company would set up a 12 million-tonne capacity green field steel plant in the mineral rich State. Accompanied by his son and Chief Financial Officer of the company, Mr Aditya Mittal, the NRI businessman met the Orissa Chief Minister, Mr Naveen Patnaik, before making his plans public.

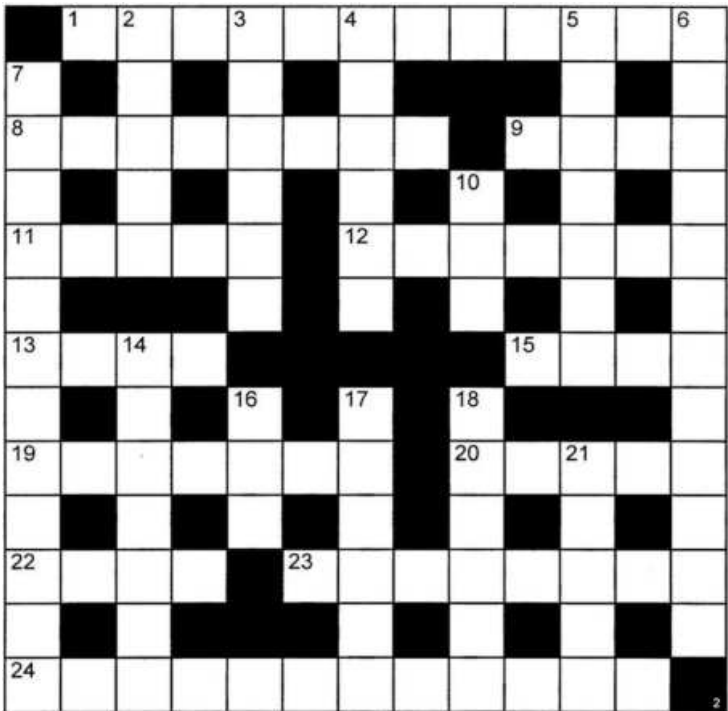
Panic selling shakes Sensex

Rumours that the Prime Minister, Dr Manmohan Singh, may resign following the Government’s failure to sustain momentum in PSU disinvestments, triggered panic selling during the latter half of the trading session on Friday. All frontline indices, after registering smart gains in early trade, plunged over 2 per cent. By the time an official denial from the PMO came through, the markets had closed, dealers said.

Panel moots fiscal sops for Intel

Global chip giant Intel’s plans for establishing a manufacturing base in the country has got a boost, with the Investment Commission recommending to the Government that the semiconductor major be given a set of fiscal concessions.

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2688



EASY

ACROSS

- Lacking politeness (12)
- Fearless (8)
- In this place (4)
- Still, passive (5)
- A parvenu (7)
- Glove thrown down as challenge (4)
- Estrange one from a habit (4)
- Weather pattern of region (7)
- William _____, William II (5)
- Form of words for swearing (4)
- Praying-desk (4-4)
- Platform for putting ashore (7-5)

DOWN

- Fibre from Agave, Bromelia etc (5)
- Bring into being (6)
- Without a like (6)
- Carry out surgical procedure (7)
- Cooked with sugar and lemon juice or vinegar (5-3-4)
- Spanish establishment in Vienna (6-6)
- Employ (3)
- Shine as reflection from wet surface (7)
- Move from side to side (tail) (3)
- ‘The tongue’ (3,3)
- Silver (6)
- Lively Scottish country-dance (5)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2687

ACROSS 1. Static 8. Noise 9. Provost 11. Trumpery 12. Share 15. Lass 16. Spy 17. Anew 19. Edify 21. Consider 24. Revival 25. Eider 26. Others

DOWN 2. Torch 3. Tovarish 4. Cast 5. Gnome 6. File 7. Deny 10. Trumpeter 12. Sole 13. Sandwich 14. Sway 18. Mitre 20. Flair 21. Clef 22. Node 23. Redo

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

- Rude way in which our cot is used (12)
- Brave way for one to end trip (8)
- At this point a man will join the Sappers (4)
- Passive about the rent one used for it (5)
- Pretentious and vulgar way it puts rat out (7)
- It used to be a pledge for fruit or marijuana (4)
- A new way to put one on solids (4)
- What the weather’s like, etc, around Peruvian capital (7)
- The second William to give us rugby union around February 1 (5)
- One swears it will be a hot ensemble (4)
- At which to pray to die pure, one being involved in ti (4-4)
- Where to put ashore and get a sling for it (7-5)

DOWN

- Fibre one can let the first nine supply (5)
- Make a fuss about a Mediterranean island (6)
- In endless queue it could be nothing like it (6)
- Nothing to repeat perhaps, so work in the theatre (7)
- Chinese dish for pudding, as round as can be (5-3-4)
- Here the students are up to being taught (6-6)
- Habit the English have: first, it’s American (3)
- Let sign be put out, and it will shine in the wet (7)
- A witty fellow who won’t quite go to war (3)
- One’s tongue may be a source of irritation (3,3)
- Silver for the rent Georgia put out (6)
- Throw it for full enjoyment of pleasure (5)

QUICKLY.

Cochin Shipyard OFS gets strong bids over ₹2,900 cr



New Delhi: Institutional investors on Tuesday placed bids exceeding ₹2,900 crore for the government's stake sale in Cochin Shipyard, significantly over-subscribing the portion reserved for them. Non-retail buyers put in bids for over 2.10 crore shares against around 59.66 lakh shares in the base offer size reserved for them, according to the exchange data. "Offer for Sale in Cochin Shipyard Ltd received an overwhelming response from the investors and was oversubscribed 3.52 times on day one. The government has decided to exercise the entire green shoe option," DIPAM Secretary Arunish Chawla tweeted. Retail investors can bid for the OFS on July 8. [m](#)

SEBI clears open market buybacks from August 1

New Delhi: The Securities and Exchange Board of India has notified rules to reintroduce share buybacks through stock exchanges, allowing companies to repurchase their own shares in the open market starting August 1, while capping the execution period at 66 working days. The new rules allow firms to carry out buybacks through regular trading mechanisms. The move is aimed at improving flexibility and execution efficiency, while potentially enhancing the attractiveness of buybacks as a capital allocation tool for listed companies. SEBI had phased out open-market buybacks in 2025, citing concerns over uneven treatment of shareholders and tax-related distortions. [m](#)

Trent shares crash 12.4% as Q1 revenue update disappoints Street

COUNTER STRIKE. Revenue per store declined about 5% y-o-y, raising concerns over slow growth of new stores

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Shares of Trent Limited ended Tuesday's session down 12.44 per cent on the NSE, closing at ₹2,927.80 against a previous close of ₹3,343.80, one of the steepest single-day falls for the Tata Group retailer, after its Q1FY27 revenue update missed analyst expectations. The stock hit an intraday low of ₹2,920.

Motilal Oswal flagged the results as "slightly weaker than expectations," noting Trent's 19 per cent y-o-y standalone revenue of ₹5,666 crore missed their 22 per cent estimate. The brokerage flagged that revenue per store declined ap-

proximately 5 per cent y-o-y, raising concerns about slower ramp-up of newer stores or cannibalisation at select locations and warned the miss "would likely lead to correction in the stock," while retaining a 'Buy'.

Nishchal Jain, Quant Researcher at Share.Market by PhonePe, attributed the sell-off to a valuation correction after the stock's 50 per cent rally from its March lows, noting rapid store expansion had triggered localised cannibalisation and a 12.2 per cent drop in revenue per square foot. He said the correction as "a healthy valuation consolidation rather than structural decay," recommending existing holders 'Hold' or 'Accumulate on Dips' and advising fresh in-

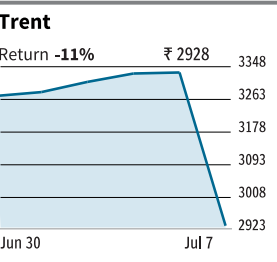
Mixed take

	Outlook	Target(₹)
Motilal Oswal	Buy	3,500
Morgan Stanley	Overweight	3,151
Goldman Sachs	Neutral	4,080
Macquarie	Outperform	3,600
Bernstein	Outperform	3,500
Citi	Sell	2,733

vestors to consider staggered buying near key technical floors.

TARGET PRICE CUT

However, global brokerages are divided. Bernstein while maintaining its 'Outperform' rating on Trent, cut the target price to ₹3,500 from ₹5,000, saying the company's investment narrative over the past three years had overwhelmingly centred on



Zudio, whose rapid store expansion transformed the company's growth trajectory.

Macquarie also maintained its 'OP' rating and price target of ₹3,600, saying: "We acknowledge that the sequential moderation in sales growth momentum is likely to weigh on near-term performance. However, we see Trent's value positioning, and the improving out-

look on consumer demand aiding a growth recovery."

Goldman Sachs maintained its 'Neutral' rating with a target price of ₹4,080 and said the Q1 update was on its expected lines.

Morgan Stanley also maintained its 'Overweight' rating but with a reduced target price of ₹3,151. According to it, the first-quarter revenue growth was slightly below estimates but it expects EBITDA margin expansion of around 100 basis points y-o-y. Citi described Zudio's seasonal store additions as healthy but remained cautious due to weakening store productivity, competition and potential cannibalisation risks. It reiterated its 'Sell' rating with a target price of ₹2,733.

SBI Funds Management IPO: Major sovereign funds likely to pump in \$1.2 b

Reuters
Mumbai

SBI Funds Management will draw investments from Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA) and Singapore's GIC as part of its \$1.2 billion initial public offering, two sources with direct knowledge of the matter said.

SBI Funds Management, a joint venture between State Bank of India and Europe's largest asset manager Amundi, manages assets worth ₹12.5 lakh crore as of end-March 2026.

It is expected to be valued at around \$12.3 billion, the sources said, with SBI and



Amundi selling a collective 10 per cent of their shares in the joint venture, as part of the issue.

The IPO, likely to open next week, will kick off a busy pipeline of public offerings in the second half of the year, with Reliance Jio and National Stock Exchange (NSE)

mega listings expected before the end of 2026.

SBI Funds Management, GIC, Amundi and ADIA declined to comment. SBI did not respond to an emailed request for comment.

According to capital market data provider Prime Database, 251 companies are planning to raise ₹4.93 lakh crore (\$51.7 billion) and waiting to come to market.

STRONG DEMAND

SBI Funds Management's IPO is drawing strong demand from large domestic institutional investors along with top foreign investors from Singapore and the West

Aisa, the sources said. "The offering has commitments worth nearly five times of the amount reserved for institutional investors," one of the two sources said.

Despite the strong institutional demand, the fund house plans to keep 50 per cent of the offer reserved for individual investors, the source said.

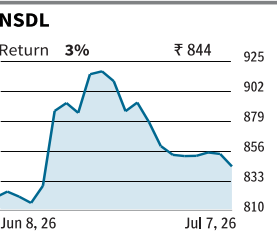
SBI Funds Management's public offer will be India's largest IPO since early 2026 after the Iran war led to a rise in oil prices, hurting investment sentiment toward the South Asian economy, heavily dependent on imported fuel.

SEBI allows depositories to use investor protection fund income for expenses

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) on Tuesday allowed depositories (CDSL and NSDL) to utilise up to 5 per cent of the annual interest or income earned from the Investor Protection Fund (IPF) corpus to meet certain operational expenses.

From September, depositories can use the interest or income generated from the IPF towards expenses related to dedicated employees of the respective IPF trusts, as well as administrative and statutory costs such as taxes,



audit fees and charity commissioner fees. "In case the expenses exceed the above limit, such excess expenses shall be borne by the depository and, in case of non-utilisation of such amount in the same financial year, the same shall be ploughed back into the IPF," SEBI said. Earlier, the entire interest

or income earned from such investments were treated as part of the IPF corpus.

CORPUS ALLOCATION

Under the revised framework, at least 95 per cent of the annual interest or income earned from IPF investments must be ploughed back into the IPF corpus.

SEBI has directed depositories to put in place the necessary systems for implementation, amend their bye-laws, rules and regulations wherever required and bring the revised provisions to the notice of market participants, including investors, while also publishing them on their websites.

Cult.fit files IPO papers to raise ₹950 crore through fresh issue

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Fitness and wellness platform Cult.fit has filed its draft red herring prospectus (DRHP) with the Securities and Exchange Board of India for an initial public offering, comprising a fresh issue of equity shares worth ₹950 crore and an offer for sale (OFS) of up to 17.86 crore shares by existing investors.

The Bengaluru-based company, formerly known as Curefit Healthcare Pvt Ltd, reported a 36.3 per cent y-o-y increase in revenue from operations to ₹1,720.6 crore in FY26, compared with ₹1,262.9 crore in FY25, according to the DRHP. The company also posted a significant improvement in profitability, with adjusted EBITDA margin improving to 8.41 per cent in FY26 from a negative 2.76 per cent a year earlier.

FUND UTILISATION

The proceeds from the fresh



issue will be used to repay borrowings, expand its network of Cult Elite and Cult Neo fitness centres, invest in its subsidiary, Cultsport, to open new exclusive brand outlets, fund lease-related payments for existing centres, undertake brand marketing initiatives, and meet general corporate requirements.

According to the DRHP, Cult.fit is India's largest fitness services provider by the number of fitness centres, operating a network of 708 centres across 77 cities as of March 31, 2026.

The company said it had nearly 9.9 lakh paid members for its fitness services business during FY26 and shipped more than 4.23 mil-

lion fitness products during the year.

The company has built a diversified business model, with fitness services accounting for around 70 per cent of revenue and fitness products for the remaining 30 per cent. Besides gym memberships, Cult.fit sells fitness apparel, footwear, equipment, recovery products and accessories under the Cultsport brand.

TECHNOLOGY FOCUS

The company said technology remains central to its operations, powering personalised workout recommendations, AI-driven decision-making, capacity optimisation and service delivery across its online and offline platforms.

Axis Capital, Goldman Sachs (India), Jefferies India, JF Financial and Morgan Stanley India are the book-running lead managers to the issue.

The equity shares are proposed to be listed on the BSE and NSE.

BROKER'S CALL.

IIFL Capital

ADANI POWER (BUY)

Target: ₹240

CMP: ₹218.05

We like Adani Power's strategy of capturing counter-cyclical arbitrage in asset creation, which earns outsized returns in a structurally 'utility' sector. With a large growth pipeline, industry-leading execution and complementary group renewables and energy-management businesses, we estimate Adani Power can quadruple EBITDA by FY33-35E.

Adani Power's willingness to take anti-consensus, counter-cyclical bets has translated into the best returns in the segment. It assembled a 7.3-GW portfolio of stressed assets at an average capital cost of ₹4.2 crore/MW, which now earn a median book RoE of 50 per cent. On the same logic, ordering boiler, turbine, generator equipment ahead of the coal-capex revival locked in capex of ₹10 crore/MW, c. 20 per cent below peers, which, we estimate, yields 350-400 bps higher RoE at comparable tariffs.

We expect Adani Power's free cash flow from operations to rise from c. ₹17,000 crore in FY26 to c. ₹57,000 crore on full portfolio buildout, with optionality from planned moves into nuclear (10-GW capacity target by 2035) and hydro (5-GW JV with Druk Green Power, Bhutan), as well. We forecast a c.20 per cent EBITDA CAGR over FY26-29E as some under-construction projects commission, making it among the fastest-growing non-renewable power gencos in India. Our SoTP-based 12-month TP of ₹240/share values Adani Power at an implied FY28E EV/EBITDA of 20x, above the coverage median of 11.1x, reflecting its faster growth and superior profitability.

InCred Equities

MANKIND PHARMA (ADD)

Target: ₹2,821

CMP: ₹2,531.50

After years of growth led by distribution reach and prescription volume, Mankind Pharma is re-orienting towards research-led, niche and specialty therapies where competition is thinner. A calculated move into low-competition specialty niches is a more achievable route to above-market growth if execution follows. Chronic segment's outperformance has narrowed to 1.1x the IPM rate in FY26 from 1.2-1.3x historically. The ₹13,770-crore acquisition of Bharat Serums and Vaccines (BSV) is the clearest expression of the pivot, making Mankind Pharma the domestic gynaecology leader (10.4 per cent share) and adding high-barrier biologics. Mankind Pharma's large medical representative force is the engine that commercialises acquired and in-licensed products, deepening their reach faster than the original owners could, and giving it a low-cost lever to scale future launches. But cross-selling, fertility clinic reach and export registrations have been built over several years, and thus BSV is a long-term contributor that strengthens the franchise instead of adding near-term growth. We value Mankind Pharma at 44x FY28F EPS of ₹64.1 for a target price of ₹2,821. At about 51x trailing earnings, the stock currently trades at a premium to domestic formulation-led peers, a premium we feel its chronic and-specialty quality justifies but which leaves limited room for slippage on the acute segment's volume recovery or the BSV ramp-up from new launches.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

TODAY'S PICK.

Godrej Properties (₹2,040.05): BUY

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl_research_bureau

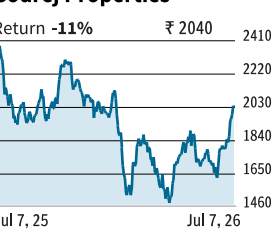
The stock of Godrej Properties has been steadily rallying over the last month. Last week, it broke out of a key resistance level at ₹1,930, indicating strong bullish momentum.

Going ahead, the price is likely to decline, possibly to ₹1,970. The correction might extend to ₹1,930. Either way, the stock is likely to resume the rally from the ₹1,970-1,930 price region.

Once the uptrend resumes, the stock can appreciate to ₹2,500 over the medium term.

Therefore, participants can buy the stock now at ₹2,040 and accumulate at ₹1,970. Place

Godrej Properties



stop-loss at ₹1,870. When the price rises to ₹2,275, raise the stop-loss to ₹2,175.

Tighten the stop-loss further to ₹2,320 when the stock touches ₹2,400. Book profits at ₹2,500.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

24410	» Nifty 50 Futures				
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
24340	24250	24600	24700	Buy if the contract rebounds from 24340; stop-loss can be 24250.	
₹829	» HDFC Bank				
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
820	805	842	850	The trend is up; go long at 829 and 810; place a stop-loss at 800.	
₹1071	» Infosys				
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1055	1028	1110	1160	The stock is likely to rally; buy at 1055 and keep stop-loss at 1028.	
₹288	» ITC				
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
286	278	294	300	The stock is likely to stay flat for the day; refrain from trading.	
₹244	» ONGC				
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
242	238	248	250	The intraday outlook is bullish; go long now with stop-loss at 240.	
₹1306	» Reliance Ind.				
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1290	1275	1325	1345	Buy the stock if it rebounds from 1290; keep a stop-loss at 1270.	
₹1037	» SBI				
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1020	1000	1055	1080	The stock might stay sideways; no fresh trades are suggested.	
₹2095	» TCS				
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2050	2000	2120	2170	Go long if the stock breaks out of 2120; stop-loss can be at 2080.	

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers					▼ 31.65 pts.
	Close(F)	Pts	PE	W(%)	
Infosys	1071.80	22.68	14.75	3.37	
Titan	4604.20	10.80	80.56	1.70	
Eternal Ltd.	289.40	9.47	763.06	1.87	
TCS	2096.10	8.59	15.34	1.52	
Bajaj Finance	1042.50	7.84	33.57	2.50	
HCL Tech	1168.20	7.83	19.04	1.10	
Tech Mahindra	1447.50	5.69	29.52	0.82	
SBI Life	1832.30	4.38	74.41	0.74	
Maruti Suzuki	14538.00	2.34	31.14	1.70	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	243.07	2.20	102.83	0.71	
Eicher Motors	7536.00	1.94	37.51	0.93	
HDFC Life	572.45	1.94	64.60	0.55	
Bajaj Finserv	1885.30	1.85	15.34	0.98	
Bajaj Auto	10109.50	1.77	26.72	1.00	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1066.80	1.38	25.04	1.34	
Hind Unilever	2208.80	1.32	49.04	1.75	
ITC	288.75	1.05	17.21	2.49	
TataConsumerProduct	1125.00	1.01	71.98	0.66	
Axis Bank	1341.00	0.88	15.71	3.45	
JSW Steel	12646.00	0.66	11.95	1.05	
Kotak Bank	381.70	0.64	19.68	2.52	
State Bank	1038.10	0.36	11.06	3.84	
ONGC	244.18	0.24	6.82	1.15	
Bharti Airtel	1925.80	0.07	34.69	5.24	
NestleIndia	1471.80	-0.30	81.11	0.94	
UltraTech Cement	11649.00	-0.31	41.92	1.23	
Int'lGlobeAvi	5395.00	-0.67	0.00	1.09	
Wipro	173.00	-0.83	13.70	0.44	
NMDC	3196.40	-0.94	21.35	2.55	
PowerGrid Corp	238.35	-1.04	16.60	1.15	
Apollo Hosp	8837.00	-1.16	63.45	0.81	
Dr Reddys Lab	1354.60	-1.77	27.19	0.74	
Coal India	428.95	-1.78	8.51	0.92	
Grasim Ind	3190.90	-1.82	21.08	1.08	
HDFC Bank	629.30	-1.84	16.12	11.37	
Tata Steel	149.79	-1.95	21.76	1.40	
NTPC	354.20	-2.12	12.47	1.50	
Sun Pharma	1903.40	-2.17	39.68	1.80	
Tata Motors PV	342.30	-2.17	4202.11	0.64	
Max Healthcare	1118.40	-2.29	75.46	0.75	
Asian Paints	2731.40	-2.32	59.62	1.11	
Cipla	1435.50	-2.32	38.37	0.73	
Hindalco	969.50	-2.45	16.27	1.26	
Adani Ports	1833.90	-4.91	33.06	1.21	
Bharat Elec	419.15	-5.01	50.54	1.34	
Adani Enter	3107.20	-6.26	40.62	0.80	
L&T	3991.90	-12.55	28.97	4.18	
Reliance Ind	1308.40	-19.03	18.49	7.91	
ICICI Bank	1414.70	-19.09	17.52	9.07	
Trent Ltd.	2927.80	-30.23	90.70	0.87	
Pts: Impact on index movement					

Nifty Next 50 Movers					▼ 437.15 pts.
	Close(F)	Pts	PE	W(%)	
Ltintindtree	3858.50	35.66	22.97	1.45	
Bplcl	3119.35	34.45	5.27	5.58	
Adani Energy Solutions .	1651.00	27.14	82.89	2.20	
Indian Hotels Co.	74.95	20.07	47.25	2.66	
United Spirits .	1439.40	10.48	56.08	1.72	
Torrent Pharma	4856.70	10.46	76.88	2.07	
Hdc	2782.40	5.98	24.87	1.85	
Indian Oilcorp	1421.58	5.48	46.00	2.15	
Macrotech Developers .	1102.55	5.41	32.11	1.24	
Tvs Motor Corp .	3712.70	5.30	53.36	3.54	
Pidilint	1622.30	4.90	68.83	2.04	
Zydusfusions	1153.00	3.74	22.64	1.17	
Cholamandilam&fin	1853.40	3.68	20.20	2.25	
Tata Capital	352.60	3.61	30.60	0.72	
Shree Cement	26710.00	3.14	55.11	1.45	
Avenuecorp	4070.90	2.93	89.40	2.66	
Union Bank	161.00	0.80	3.63	1.26	
Tata Power	377.20	-1.71	23.55	2.55	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	189.10	-1.89	16.77	0.73	
Britannia Ind	5447.00	-2.59	51.71	2.60	
Godrej Consumer	1097.20	-4.00	60.31	1.79	
Muthofin	3124.50	-4.12	11.83	3.36	
Bosch	41935.00	-4.83	44.60	1.48	
Punjab Natk Bank	1917.90	-5.05	6.46	1.45	
Welspun Corp	1078.60	-7.61	12.22	3.38	
Gail (India)	1740.1	-8.06	15.09	1.90	
Hinduja Motor India .	1980.50	-9.99	29.63	1.15	
Amul& Cements	435.90	-10.05	19.71	1.10	
Mazgaon Dock	2523.20	-11.29	63.94	1.87	
Bank Of Orissa	247.85	-11.42	6.39	1.87	
Hind Ce	591.60	-13.04	15.22	2.02	
Siemens Energy India .	3368.90	-13.32	91.60	1.21	
Canara Bank	125.03	-14.09	6.34	1.70	
Abb India	6978.00	-14.61	93.58	1.49	
Solar Industries	1826.00	-19.35	95.19	1.81	
Siemens	3495.00	-19.84	81.20	1.25	
Adani Power	218.07	-21.65	22.42	6.67	
Indiansteronaerotics	400.00	-22.41	32.28	3.39	
Sarnwardmotherinternatnl	1433.37	-25.38	37.04	2.57	
Jindal Steel	10335.40	-26.16	31.43	1.56	
Cp Power & Ind Sol	191.00	-29.24	118.83	2.53	
Adani Green Energy	1519.00	-29.67	125.92	2.07	
Adani Power Cy	425.00	-29.99	22.42	6.67	
Dural	356.25	-31.12	5.75	1.81	
Rivac Bank	6771.50	-32.03	70.00	3.49	
Power Finance	4131.35	-33.93	40.05	2.44	
Vedanta	27.05	-34.54	6.78	1.89	
Oil	651.10	-41.74	36.51	1.69	
Amminis India	5471.50	-42.36	64.22	2.60	
Brown Beverages.	484.25	-42.58	10.53	2.69	
Pts: Impact on index movement					

QUICKLY.

RBI to conduct ₹25,000 cr overnight VRR auction

Mumbai: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Tuesday said it will conduct an overnight variable rate repo (VRR) auction for a notified amount of ₹25,000 crore on July 8. The auction will take place between 9.30 am and 10 am on Wednesday, and the funds will be reversed on July 9, according to the RBI's notification. Currently, liquidity in the banking system is estimated to be in surplus of around ₹1.19 lakh crore as of July 6, according to the RBI's data. **PTI**

MakeMyTrip launches OneCircle rewards system

Mumbai: MakeMyTrip will offer its users reward points equal to 10 per cent of their spend on hotel bookings on its platform. The online travel agency on Tuesday launched its rewards programme 'OneCircle' covering 13,376 properties, including hotels, homestays and villas in 134 destinations across 39 countries. One reward point will equal one rupee. **OUR BUREAU**

Sharp surge in insurance complaints sparks service quality concerns

G Naga Sridhar
Hyderabad

A sharp surge in customer grievances in the general insurance sector has raised fresh concerns over claims management, service quality and product communication, according to the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).

The unresolved grievances could undermine policyholder confidence and pose broader financial stability risks, RBI said.

According to the RBI's *Financial Stability Report*, the number of reported grievances in the general insurance sector nearly tripled to 1.78 lakh in 2025-26 from 2021-22, signalling persistent shortcomings in customer service and claims settlement.

"The steep and sustained rise in grievances indicates systemic shortfalls in claims management, service quality and product communication," it said in the report.

The RBI cautioned that if left unaddressed, conduct risks of this magnitude could erode policyholder trust, weaken renewal rates and eventually emerge as a financial stability concern if they trigger large-scale policy exits.

LIFE INSURANCE

In contrast, the life insurance sector has shown a marked improvement in customer grievance trends.

Reported complaints, which had crossed 1.5 lakh in 2021-22, declined to 1.2 lakh in 2025-26, reflecting better market conduct, improved product suitability and stronger post-sale servicing, the report said.

The sustained decline in

Mercedes-Benz India reports record H1 sales, up 9%; EV mix reaches 14%

IN THE FAST LANE. Growth driven by a strong demand for premium, top-end electric vehicles

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Mercedes-Benz India reported its highest-ever first-half sales, retailing 9,768 vehicles in January-June 2026, up 9 per cent from 9,013 units in H1 2025, while second-quarter sales rose 10 per cent to 4,637 units (Q2FY26) from 4,238 units in Q2 FY25, as demand for premium electric vehicles and top-end luxury models continued to outpace the company's overall growth.

Battery electric vehicles now account for 14 per cent of Mercedes-Benz India's Q2 sales, roughly double their earlier contribution, underscoring the accelerating shift towards electrification in India's luxury car market.

The luxury car maker has said its franchise partners are expected to invest more than ₹450 crore over the next two years to add more than 20 luxury outlets across India, including its entry into



DEMAND SURGE. Premium battery EVs priced above ₹1.4 crore recorded 85 per cent growth in the second quarter

Varanasi, while expanding its presence in Mumbai, Delhi NCR, Pune and Hyderabad.

BUYING TREND

The headline sales numbers mask an even bigger shift in buying behaviour. While overall volumes grew in single digits, Mercedes' strongest momentum came from its most expensive vehicles.

Sales of top-end luxury

(TEL) models, including the Mercedes-Maybach range, S-Class, AMG models, EQS SUV and the newly-launched V-Class, grew more than 20 per cent in the first half, taking their share to a record 28 per cent of total sales.

Mercedes-AMG deliveries surged 50 per cent, reflecting growing demand for ultra-luxury and performance vehicles.

"H1 2026 has shown in-

creased preference for our top-end vehicles, with the share now reaching an all-time high of 28 per cent, fuelled by the introduction and growing demand for the new V-Class and the 50 per cent growth trajectory achieved by the AMG portfolio," Santosh Iyer, Managing Director and CEO, Mercedes-Benz India, said.

NEXT GROWTH ENGINE

The company's electric vehicle business is expanding much faster than its overall operations.

Premium battery electric vehicles priced above ₹1.4 crore recorded 85 per cent growth in the second quarter, led by the EQS SUV, while the newly-launched CLA BEV strengthened demand in the entry luxury segment.

The CLA BEV has already sold out its initial allocation, with waiting periods stretching five to six months, suggesting affluent buyers are increasingly embracing elec-

tric mobility. The performance highlights the widening divide between India's luxury and mass-market passenger vehicle segments.

Customers are not simply buying more luxury cars; they are buying more expensive ones.

LONG WAITING PERIOD

Waiting periods for several TEL models range from four months to as long as one year for the AMG G 63, while the long-wheelbase E-Class remained India's highest-selling luxury car during the first half.

Mercedes' entry luxury portfolio also expanded 29 per cent in the second quarter, supported by the CLA BEV and GLA SUV.

The trend comes even as the broader passenger vehicle industry grapples with slower demand and elevated dealer inventories, underscoring the resilience of affluent consumers and the growing appeal of premium electric vehicles.

'If India wants higher ethanol blending, it needs a clear roadmap for older cars'

bl.interview

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

As India recalibrates its proposed transition to E25 petrol after concerns over vehicle compatibility during the E20 rollout, Mercedes-Benz India Managing Director and CEO Santosh Iyer believes policymakers must now focus on managing the country's existing vehicle fleet alongside introducing higher ethanol blends.

Edited excerpts:

The government has slowed the proposed rollout of E25 after concerns emerged during the E20 transition. Has India's challenge now shifted from engineering new vehicles to managing the country's existing vehicle fleet?

There is a lot of anxiety among customers, but in our case there is no reason to worry.

Our cars are compliant, our latest products are already E25-ready and our new vehicles meet the required emission standards. The bigger question is what happens to the older set of vehicles already on the road. If the government has the aspiration for higher ethanol blending, it should also create a roadmap that allows different fuel grades so customers can choose fuel suited to their vehicles. Different fuel grades could also have different pricing structures. As manufacturers, we will comply with whatever guidelines are notified, provided we are given reasonable timelines.



We shouldn't mix up new vehicles with older ones. If a vehicle has been certified to run on E20, it should remain fully covered under warranty

SANTOSH IYER
Mercedes-Benz India MD and CEO

There is also concern around compatibility, replacement parts and fuel-system issues in older vehicles...

We shouldn't mix up new vehicles with older ones. If a vehicle has been certified to run on E20, it should run on E20 and remain fully covered under warranty.

I don't see any risk with new cars. The questions are more relevant for vehicles sold before the transition because technology differs across manufacturers. Some of the anxiety in the market is also being amplified by fuel adulteration rather than the fuel itself.

Mercedes today offers petrol, diesel, plug-in hybrids and battery electric vehicles. Does that reinforce your view that customers, not mandates, should determine the pace of the powertrain transition?

Absolutely. We have diesel, petrol, plug-in hybrids and EVs because we believe the customer should decide the pace of transformation. If customers want EVs, we are ready. The new CLA was sold out immediately after launch and almost 25 per cent of our



volumes from the entry segment because we are focused on the core and top-end markets.

Discounting has returned in parts of the luxury market. How do you view the trend?

The heavy discounting is largely confined to the ₹50-55 lakh entry-luxury segment, where customers are more price sensitive. We have consciously chosen not to participate aggressively because our strategy is based on value rather than volume.

We have already retailed nearly 10,000 vehicles in the first half, almost 28 per cent of them from our top-end portfolio, and continue to carry an order book of around 2,000 vehicles.

That gives us confidence that customers continue to value the product and the brand rather than simply the price.

Having seen a record first half in the current year, how do you see the second half?

We remain cautiously optimistic because consumer demand continues to be healthy and our product launches have been well received. The biggest challenge is currency volatility. We had hoped to revise prices from July 1, but delayed the decision when the euro softened to around 106. It has since moved back to around 109, which means we will have to take a 1-2 per cent price increase, most likely in phases during July or early August.

Input costs are also rising. Even so, we continue to expect growth for both the industry and Mercedes-Benz India because the underlying demand remains strong.

Petition in SC claims E20 rollout undermines the rights of the consumer

Krishnadas Rajagopal
New Delhi



A petition has been filed in the Supreme Court claiming an element of "silent compulsion" in the E20 petrol rollout while seeking full disclosure on chemical composition and safeguards that may be in place in the case of legacy vehicles.

The petition filed by Supreme Court advocate and petitioner-in-person Narendra Kumar Goswami, besides invoking the fundamental freedoms of equal treatment by the law, right to earn a livelihood and lead a dignified life, raised Article 300A (right to property) and the Consumer Protection Act of 2019 to contend that the right to know the composition, quality, standard and compatibility consequences of a product was not a "decorative consumer slogan but a constitutional requirement when the state itself creates a nationwide compulsory market".

NOT INERT ADDITIVE

Goswami said ethanol was not an inert additive. "Ethanol is hygroscopic, may affect certain fuel-system materials, has lower energy density than petrol, and may have implications for fuel efficiency, engine performance, maintenance, warranty and long-term vehicle health," the petitioner contended.

The lawyer said the Bureau of Indian Standards had issued a separate E20 specification, and the Ministry of Road Transport and High-

ways had created a staggered compatibility schedule, showing that E20 compatibility was "not universal but vehicle-specific".

"The petition does not seek to roll back India's ethanol-blending policy. It expressly accepts that energy security, reduction of crude oil imports, environmental objectives and support to farmers are legitimate policy goals. The contention in the petition is that a welfare policy cannot be implemented by keeping citizens in the dark about what they are buying, whether their vehicles can safely use it, and whether they have any meaningful alternative," Goswami said.

The petition has sought the constitution of an independent expert committee comprising representatives from the Petroleum Ministry, the Transport Ministry, BIS, and experts from recognised consumer bodies, independent automobile engineers, fuel technologists, environmental experts, public health experts and water resource experts to examine "real-world E20 compatibility".

lululemon partners with Tata CLiQ for India debut

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi



Athletic apparel and lifestyle brand lululemon is set to foray into India later this year with its first store launch in New Delhi. Its products will also be made available online.

This comes at a time when the premium athleisure brand has been focusing on expanding in international markets.

The company on Tuesday said the first store will be located in New Delhi's DLF Promenade and open later this autumn as part of the company's franchise agreement with Tata CLiQ.

At the time of the opening, Tata CLiQ will also launch the brand on its platforms Tata CLiQ Luxury and Tata CLiQ Fashion, it added.

FIRST STORE

It said its first store will also serve as a space for connection with guests, ambassadors, and local health and fitness communities.

"Bringing lululemon to India is a proud milestone for our teams as we continue to grow our brand around the world. To prepare for the opening, we have been working with Tata CLiQ to build relationships with the New

Delhi community... We are excited to welcome guests across India to lululemon in the coming months," said Sarah Clark, Senior Vice President, EMEA, lululemon. "We are gearing up to open the brand's first store in the coming months, along with its launch on Tata CLiQ platforms, and look forward to growing its omnichannel presence in the country," said Gopal Asthana, CEO, Tata CLiQ.

THE TRAVANCORE CEMENTS LIMITED
(An ISO 9001:2015 Company)
(A Govt. of Kerala Undertaking)
Nattakom, Kottayam, Kerala - 686 013.
E-mail: tcl.materials@gmail.com
Ph/Whatsapp: +91 9895358550

SUPPLY OF WHITE CEMENT CLINKER
e-Tenders are invited for the Supply of 2000MT White Clinker, suitable for manufacturing White Cement on 'CIF COCHIN BASIS'. Last date: **24.07.2026 @ 5PM**. (EMD last date: 22.07.2026) Tender ID: 2026_TCL_857367_1. For more details, visit www.tenders.kerala.gov.in. (Find "Travancore Cements Ltd" in "Tenders by organisation") (Sd/-) Managing Director

iD Fresh broadens portfolio with packaged snacks

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

iD Fresh Food has expanded into the packaged snacks category, marking another step in its transformation into a broader branded foods company as it prepares for an eventual public listing.

businessline has learnt that the company has launched a range of snacks, comprising around seven SKUs made using ragi and oats.

The portfolio includes *masala ragi* chips, *pušina ragi bhujia*, *masala* oats chips, *pušina* oats *bhujia*, corn flakes mixture, all in one mixture and butter *murukku*, according to people aware of the development.

The move comes after iD's expansion beyond its core *idli-dosa* batter business into

adjacent categories such as protein batter, pancakes, *thepla*, chutneys and protein-based *chapatis* and *parottas*.

With the latest launch, the company enters India's nearly ₹50,000 crore packaged savoury snacks market, currently dominated by established players such as Haldiram's and Bikaji Foods International.

HEALTHY SNACKING

The expansion also aligns with rising consumer demand for healthier snacking options. According to International Market Analysis Research and Consulting (IMARC Group), India's healthy snacks market was valued at \$3.13 billion in 2025 and is expected to grow to \$4.77 billion by 2034, driven by increasing health consciousness and demand



for convenient, high-protein and natural food products.

The category expansion comes as iD accelerates preparations for its next phase of growth.

NEW FACILITY

Earlier this year, the company commissioned a 40,000 sq ft manufacturing facility in Hyderabad, strengthening domestic capacity that it says

is sufficient to support growth over the next five years.

Internationally, the company continues to expand through trading partnerships rather than setting up manufacturing facilities, with operations spanning the US, the UK, Ireland, Canada and Singapore. It has previously indicated plans to add 10-15 new SKUs annually, despite existing categories such as bread and spices after pilot launches.

IPO READINESS

In another step towards IPO readiness, iD recently elevated Co-founders Jafar TK and Shamshudeen TK to its Board of Directors, underscoring its focus on strengthening governance as it expands across markets and product categories.

भारतीय वाणिज्य प्रबन्ध संस्थान बेंगलूरु
INDIAN INSTITUTE OF PLANTATION MANAGEMENT BENGALURU
(An Autonomous Organization of the Ministry of Commerce & Industry, GOI)

WALK-IN INTERVIEW

Executive – Corporate Relations & Placements on contract.
Qualification: Post Graduate with minimum 60% aggregate marks.
Desirable: MBA/MCA/PGDM or equivalent. **Experience:** More than 10 years in Placement, Corporate Relations, HR, or a related field. **Age:** Not exceeding 30 years.
Walk-in Interview: 16 July 2026 (Thursday), 10:30 AM
For detailed eligibility criteria, visit: www.iipmb.edu.in
Venue: Indian Institute of Plantation Management (IIPM), Jnana Bharathi Campus, Bengaluru – 560056.
Date: 06.07.2026
Notification: 06/2026

Sd/-
DIRECTOR

	ERNAKULAM REGIONAL CO-OPERATIVE MILK PRODUCERS' UNION LTD. Products Dairy, Edappally, Kochi-24 Ph: 949576007. e-mail: erncupdengg@milma.com		
TENDER NOTICE			
No. PD/ENGG/2026-27/383,386,387,384		07-07-2026	
E-Tender Titles	Tender Id	Bid Submission End Date	
Electrical Works at Products Dairy	2026_KCMMF_858843_1	27.07.2026 3.00 PM	
SITC of Metal Detector and Conveyor unit at Products Dairy	2026_KCMMF_859134_1	20.07.2026, 4.00 PM	
SITC of Hygiene Station at Products Dairy	2026_KCMMF_859451_1	20.07.2026, 4.00 PM	
SITC of HVAC Unit at Products Dairy	2026_KCMMF_858845_1	20.07.2026, 3.00 PM	
For More details: https://etenders.kerala.gov.in		(Sd/-) Dairy Manager	

Kerala Co-operative Milk Marketing Federation Ltd.
Milma Bhavan, Pattom P.O., Trivandrum - 695004
Ph: 0471 2786439 to 442. E-mail: projects@milma.com

TENDER NOTICE

Bid reference : KCCMMF/KHO/PROJ/571/2026
Name of work : E- tender for Dismantling, fabrication, replacement and commissioning of Existing MS Air Lock Body Shell with Stainless Steel (SS) Shell for the Second-Stage Air Lock at Cattle Feed Plant, Malampuzha, Palakkad District
Detailed tender notice available in our website www.milma.com.
08.07.2026 Sd/- **MANAGING DIRECTOR**

TATA TATA POWER
(Corporate Contracts Department)
Sahar Receiving Station, Near Hotel Leela, Andheri (E), Mumbai 400 059, Maharashtra, India
(Board Line: 022-67173188) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

The Tata Power Company Limited hereby invites Expression of Interest from eligible parties for
"Structural Repair and Rehabilitation of Cooling Water Jetty Piles, Caisson Walls and Associated Structures at Trombay Thermal Power Station, Chembur, Mumbai (Tender Ref. No.: CC27PMR008)"

For details of pre-qualification requirements, purchasing of tender document, bid security, etc., please visit Tender section of our website (URL: <https://www.tatapower.com/tender/tenders-listing>). Eligible parties willing to participate may submit their expression of interest along with the tender fee on or before 17th July, 2026.

QUICKLY.

Amrinder Singh appointed
Bahwan CyberTek's head



Chennai: IT services company Bahwan CyberTek (BCT) has announced the appointment of Amrinder Singh as Managing Director and CEO. Singh will lead BCT's next phase of growth as it shifts from human-led, labour-intensive delivery models towards autonomous, AI and agent-driven operations, said the company in a media release. Singh was previously the President and Head of EMEA and APAC, where he also led the company's GCC business. "I am excited to join Bahwan CyberTek at such an important stage in its journey and look forward to working with our customers, partners and employees to accelerate our AI and digital capabilities, deepen our breadth and depth in key markets and help our clients unlock the full potential of AI, data and analytics," said Singh. **OUR BUREAU**

NBFCs register credit growth of 14.2% in May, led by retail lending

GOOD SHOW. Gold loans surge 70% while consumer durable finance rises 42%, according to RBI data

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Non-banking finance companies (NBFCs), including housing finance companies (HFCs), registered higher credit growth of 14.2 per cent at ₹58.6 lakh crore in May 2026, compared to 11.4 per cent a year ago, on the back of robust growth in retail loans and agriculture and allied activities, per data on sectoral deployment of credit by NBFCs released by the RBI for the first time.

CREDIT GROWTH
In the reporting month, NBFCs' credit growth, however, is lower than scheduled commercial banks' (SCBs) non-food bank credit growth. SCBs reported credit growth of 17.4 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) as on May 31, 2026, up from 8.8 per cent as on May 30, 2025. Sectoral credit data of NBFCs are based on the



GOLDEN OPPORTUNITY. Gold loans were the standout performer in NBFC retail lending, driven by strong demand for secured borrowing amid elevated gold prices

sample of (i) NBFCs in upper and middle layers and (ii) HFCs, accounting for about 87 per cent of the total credit. Retail loans remained the key growth driver, expanding 19.5 per cent (y-o-y) to ₹25.2 lakh crore in May 2026 over 14.9 per cent a year ago, ac-

cording to the RBI statement. Retail loans accounted for nearly 43 per cent of the sector's overall loan book. Within retail loan, housing loan, vehicle loan and loans against gold jewellery displayed a robust growth in May 2026. Gold loans were the

standout performer in NBFC retail lending, surging nearly 70 per cent y-o-y to ₹3.3 lakh crore in May 2026, driven by strong demand for secured borrowing amid elevated gold prices. Housing loans rose 10.9 per cent to ₹8.35 lakh crore and consumer durable loans

also grew sharply 42 per cent to ₹68,814 crore, reflecting healthy consumption demand, while vehicle loans rose 14.8 per cent to ₹6.18 lakh crore.

AGRI SECTOR
Credit growth in agriculture and allied activities recorded robust growth of 17.9 per cent (y-o-y) in May 2026 against 5.0 per cent a year ago. Credit growth in services sector moderated to 16.7 per cent (y-o-y) in May 2026 against 23.9 per cent a year ago. Among the major contributors, growth (y-o-y) in credit to commercial real estate marked buoyant expansion. Credit to industry grew at a lower clip of 7.3 per cent (y-o-y) in May 2026, compared to 10.0 per cent in May 2025. The RBI said moderation in growth in industry was driven by subdued growth in infrastructure, a major constituent of the segment.

Rupee enters another 'consolidation' phase

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl research bureau



The rupee weakened over the past week, declining about 30 paise, or 0.32 per cent, to close at 94.97 against the dollar on Tuesday. The fall comes despite supportive factors, such as foreign inflows and lower crude oil prices, highlighting the stronger dollar's influence on the local currency.

RUPEE WEEKLY REVIEW.

According to NSDL data, net FPI inflows stood at about \$1.1 billion so far in July, indicating that overseas investors remain interested in Indian assets. Domestic sentiment has also improved. The benchmark Nifty 50 index is up about 2.2 per cent so far this month, reflecting a broader risk-on mood in financial markets.

LOWER CRUDE PRICES
Crude oil prices, another key factor for the rupee, have remained favourable. Brent crude futures, currently trading around \$73 per barrel, have fallen nearly 40 per cent from the \$119.5 high reached in March. While the decline has largely been driven by easing geopolitical tensions, OPEC+'s decision to increase output by 188,000 barrels per day from August could help keep prices subdued going forward.

However, the rupee has struggled to capitalise on these positives because the dollar remains firm. Although expectations of a September rate hike have moderated, the greenback continues to draw support from the view that interest rates could remain elevated for an extended period. The dollar index remains well above 100, keeping pressure on emerging-market currencies. Overall, supportive domestic factors and softer crude prices are helping cushion the rupee, but the dollar's strength continues

to limit gains. The rupee breached the 94.90 support level last week and slipped to a low of 95.49 on Monday. However, it recovered some ground on Tuesday, closing at 94.97.

The prevailing price action does not provide a clear indication of the next directional move. For now, the rupee is likely to remain within the 94.20-95.40 range. A break below 95.40 can trigger a fresh bout of weakness, dragging the currency to 95.80 and potentially to 96 thereafter. Conversely, a breakout above the 94.20 resistance can strengthen the recovery and lift the rupee towards 93.50.

The movement in the dollar index will remain crucial. The index remains comfortably above the key support at 100.50, indicating that the bulls retain the upper hand. The chart suggests that another leg of the uptrend could be underway, with the index potentially advancing to 102 in the near term. In such a scenario, the rupee may weaken towards 96. On the other hand, if the dollar index slips below 100.50, it can decline to 99.50. Such a correction could provide room for the rupee to appreciate towards 93.50. However, a fall in the dollar index below 99.50 and, consequently, a rise in the rupee beyond 93.50 appear unlikely at this stage.

OUTLOOK
The near-term outlook remains mixed. While lower crude oil prices and continued foreign inflows are supportive, a firm dollar is likely to keep the rupee under pressure. The key levels to watch are 94.20 on the upside and 95.40 on the downside.

Time opportune to revise priority sector lending norms: SBI

Our Bureau
Mumbai

State Bank of India's economic research department (ERD) has suggested revision in the priority sector lending (PSL) guidelines through an increase in the limits of various categories of loans, including home loans and education loans that qualify as PSL. Further, ERD officials suggested that infrastructure funding done by banks from their own resources should either be classified as PSL or be excluded from the calculation of ANBC (adjusted net bank credit) for PSL achievement. Also, a separate head needs to be created under 'climate sustainability fin-

ance' under PSL for activities that contribute to climate sustainability

PSL MECHANISM
The RBI had devised PSL mechanism in 1972 to ensure credit flow to underserving sectors. Since then, it has been revised periodically. "Possibly, an opportune time has now come to assess future needs of financial inclusion and priority sector lending and make policy changes needed to ensure access to finance to weaker sections in line with Viksit Bharat objective," said Soumya Kanti Ghosh, Group Chief Economic Adviser, SBI. The government's Viksit Bharat objective seeks to transform India into a de-

veloped entity by 2047. A primary economic objective is to achieve a substantial GDP, with targets ranging from \$30 trillion to \$40 trillion by 2047. Given that growth in home loan under PSL is not in tandem with growth in overall housing loan portfolio, the ERD proposed that limits to housing sector may be reasonably increased (say ₹1 crore in metro centres and ₹75 lakh for other centres). "The project cost limits also need to be increased with a provision of 25 per cent margin. We also propose other intermediated housing loans by banks may be made eligible for PSL classification," said the ERD economists. Under extent guidelines, a housing loan

will be classified as PSL if it satisfies loan limit as well as dwelling cost criteria prescribed for a particular centre. So, for centres with a population of 50 lakh and above, the maximum dwelling cost is ₹63 lakh and the loan limit is ₹50 lakh. For centres with a population of 10 lakh and above but below 50 lakh, the maximum dwelling cost is ₹57 lakh and the loan limit is ₹45 lakh. For centres with a population below 10 lakh, the maximum dwelling cost is ₹44 lakh and the loan limit is ₹35 lakh. In view of the substantial increase in the cost of education over the past few years, the ERD has proposed that the loan limit of ₹25 lakh to individuals for educational

purposes eligible for PSL classification may be reasonably increased to a higher level (for example ₹50 lakh). The ERD recommended that under PSL, the limit on bank loans to borrowers for renewable energy-based power generation and for renewable energy-based public utilities — street lighting systems, remote village electrification — be upped from ₹35 crore to ₹100 crore. For individual households (roof top solar plants), the loan limit has been proposed to be increased to ₹2 crore from ₹10 lakh per borrower. In the case of food & agro processing loan as well as agri infra loans, the ERD recommended upping the limit per borrower to ₹200 crore for individual banks, with ag-

gregate sanctioned limits of ₹500 crore per borrower (from ₹100 crore) from the banking system under agriculture PSL eligibility. In the case of social infrastructure, the ERD suggested revising upwards the loan limits for schools and healthcare facilities to ₹15 crore (from ₹8 crore) and ₹25 crore (from ₹12 crore), respectively, in all cities. **EXPORT CREDIT**
In the case of export credit, the ERD suggested either removing or enhancing the cap of ₹50 crore per exporter for PSL classification to a reasonable level of, say, ₹200 crore. It also recommended removal of the upper cap of 2 per cent of a bank's credit under PSL.

Dabur ramps up focus on premiumisation

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

As part of its premiumisation and contemporisation strategy, Dabur India has been focusing on expanding its existing brands into new categories in FY26. The company is also focusing on building digital-first brands adopting a D2C model. "In 2025-26, Dabur sharpened its innovation focus by bringing contemporary formats, premium propositions and digital-first launches to core wellness and personal care categories," the company said in its FY26 annual report. The company said it made strategic entry into "the digitally-native wellness space" with Siens by Dabur. It noted that the premium, D2C nutraceutical brand was, so far, being sold exclus-

ively on Amazon and Dabur-Shop; it has now scaled up rapidly. "This momentum is reflected in steady quarter-on-quarter growth, demonstrating Siens' ability to convert digital discovery into sustained demand. Building on this strong foundation, the brand is now poised to expand across additional platforms and adjacent high-growth categories, including sports and performance nutrition, further strengthening Dabur's play in India's premium nutraceuticals market," the company added. As part of its strategy to reimagine the role of its heritage brands, the company has extended Dabur Gulabari into the personal care space with a range of shower gels. Meanwhile, the launch of Real Cheers marked Dabur's entry into the fast-emerging cocktail mixer category.

'Sustainability in data centres is a minimal requirement for clients'

bl.interview

Vallari Sangziri
Mumbai

India's data centre boom is gathering momentum as more companies are pumping in money and looking to set up their own centres. In such a backdrop, sustainability measures have become part of boardroom discussions in a big way, according to Thiru Prakash, APAC Head at OVHcloud. More reports are flagging concerns about water and energy crisis amid rising data centre projects. To tackle this, Prakash says companies will have to overhaul their conventional cooling systems to more sustainable alternatives, stressing the need for not just GPU-ready data centres but smart data centres. *Edited excerpts:*

What is your assessment of the inflow of foreign investments coming to India?

The government has invested in terms of policies and so big cloud players are investing heavily in India. Also, we have a big workforce in India that allows different skill sets, especially in the development community. It is natural that companies set base and invest here. The power consumption currently is less than 1 per cent for data centres in India. In comparison, Singapore has 7 per cent power consumption. It means there is a huge potential of power availability in India. Hence, large investments are going in. **Considering this, does India have enough infrastructure capacity and wherewithal to take**

“We have a big workforce in India that allows different skill sets, especially in the development community”

THIRU PRAKASH
APAC Head at OVHcloud



on the many data centre projects?
Yes. The capacity is increasing. It is currently 1.5 GW. It has been projected to reach 6.5GW in 2030. Still, the key consideration is not capacity, but whether AI-ready infrastructure is available. If the infrastructure is not ready from day one, you will not meet the AI demand. Solutions like the direct-to-chip cooling we started 20 years ago put us in a position to align with India's growth.

have direct-to-chip cooling and water-cooling technology. Others will have to go through a learning curve, lots of operational issues.

Would you say that sustainability has effectively become a business lever?
Sustainability is no longer a word, it is a minimum requirement to be met. We must be in place to ensure efficiency. Our customers are looking for a more sustainable AI rather than just an expansionary AI. We need to have smart infrastructure in place. For example, we have put in sensors in our data centres that collect data on CPUs, cooling modules, servers, racks. This data is then analysed for predictive analysis and to see which server requires the water flow or energy. The flow is adjusted to the demand of that server for that period. Globally, we're

looking at how we can tap local weather stations and obtain that data and attune our cooling efficiency. **Do you see that mindset in client conversations with CIOs or CISOs?**
Of course, everybody's mind is in sustainability. We give a second and a third lifecycle to components that allow the customer to access diverse components and services in a very cost-effective manner.

How has your business segment performed in India over the last six months?
Growth is still a priority and we are looking into bringing in AI infrastructure. OVH already has an AI-ready infrastructure from day one. Our technology is more direct-chip cooling and we have deployed that technology in India. That is how we are going to grow.

Maersk, Hapag-Lloyd shift Gemini Cooperation service between Asia and Europe to Suez Canal

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai



BUSINESS AS USUAL. Suez Canal is the most sustainable and efficient maritime corridor linking Asia and Europe

Global shipping lines Maersk and Hapag-Lloyd have jointly decided to reroute one of their Gemini Cooperation services through the Suez Canal, marking a cautious return to the Red Sea corridor after months of diversions around the Cape of Good Hope. The companies announced that the AE15 service will transition to the trans-Suez route following a detailed assessment of the security situation in the Red Sea. The first vessel to operate under the revised routing will be the *Majestic Maersk*. The restructuring re-

moves the Istanbul call and restores service via the Suez Canal, bypassing the Cape of Good Hope, resulting in shorter transit times between Asia and the eastern Mediterranean. Container shipping lines began avoiding the Suez Canal and the Red Sea in late 2023 after Yemen's Houthi

movement intensified attacks on commercial vessels transiting the Bab el-Mandeb Strait, citing the Israel-Hamas conflict. The attacks prompted most major global container carriers, including Maersk and Hapag-Lloyd, to suspend Red Sea transits and reroute ships around the Cape of Good Hope from

December 2023. While the diversion added 10-14 days to voyages between Asia and Europe, it also increased fuel consumption, vessel operating costs and freight rates and disrupted global shipping schedules. **CAUTIOUS APPROACH**
The move by Maersk-Hapag Lloyd is expected to shorten transit times compared with the longer Cape of Good Hope route that carriers adopted following attacks on commercial vessels in the Red Sea. Shipping lines said the Suez Canal remains the fastest, most sustainable and most efficient maritime corridor linking Asia and Europe, making it critical for global supply chains.

IPO will enable us to invest in frontier tech, strengthen manufacturing: Jupiter International

Mithun Dasgupta
Kolkata

Jupiter International, one of India's largest standalone solar photovoltaic cell manufacturers, is considering an IPO within the next 10 to 12 months to raise capital for expanding its manufacturing capacities, accelerating technology adoption and strengthening its integrated solar manufacturing capabilities.

NAGPUR FACILITY
The company has a capital expenditure plan of around ₹3,500 crore for the current financial year to develop its Nagpur facility, which will manufacture next-genera-

tion solar cells, modules and wafers, establishing an integrated photovoltaic manufacturing ecosystem across the solar value chain. Total investment for the Nagpur facility is expected to be ₹10,900 crore. "The next phase of India's solar manufacturing journey will be defined by technology leadership, scale and vertical integration. As we expand into advanced cell architectures, wafer manufacturing and next-generation R&D, we require long-term patient capital to accelerate this transformation," said Dhruv Sharma, CEO, Jupiter International Ltd. "An IPO will, therefore, not merely be a fund-rais-

ing exercise; it will be a strategic milestone that will enable us to invest in frontier technologies, strengthen domestic manufacturing capabilities and build a globally competitive solar manufacturing platform," said Sharma. The company started its journey as a cell manufacturer in 2009 when it commercialised its first solar photovoltaic cell manufacturing unit with 30 MW annual capacity in Himachal Pradesh's Baddi. **OUTPUT EXPANSION**
The second unit at the Baddi facility came up in 2016. Last month, the company expanded its solar cell

manufacturing capacity at the facility from 2GW to 3.25GW by inaugurating its fourth unit, adding 1.25 GW of TOPCon (tunnel oxide passivated contact) solar cell manufacturing capacity by investing ₹550 crore. "Solar cells represent the technological heart of a photovoltaic value chain. While modules integrate components, it is the cell that determines efficiency, energy yield, reliability and long-term performance. Cell manufacturing demands deep process engineering, advanced materials science, and continuous innovation and is capex-intensive," Sharma pointed out.

QUICKLY.

Railway Ministry clears recruitment to 4,098 posts

New Delhi: The Railway Ministry has approved the recruitment of 4,098 technical personnel across railway zones. Officials said the Ministry had decided to fill vacancies across 35 technical categories, including junior engineers, depot material superintendents and chemical and metallurgical assistants. A recent circular addressed to the General Managers of all zones stated that it had assessed the vacancy positions highlighted by the zones and based on that assessment, directed the initiation of the recruitment process.

Centre clears ₹1,237 crore PM SETU skilling initiative

New Delhi: The government on Tuesday approved the pan-India roll-out of the ₹60,000-crore Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs (PM-SETU) scheme across 200 Industrial Training Institute clusters, while also clearing strategic investment plans worth ₹1,237.58 crore.

UP Data Centre Policy 2026 sends strong signal to market, say experts

UPDATED VIEW. Special emphasis placed on GPU-based infra, energy efficiency and sustainable development

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

The Uttar Pradesh (UP) Data Centre Policy-2026's focus on artificial intelligence-ready capacity, graphics processing unit (GPU) infrastructure, sustainability and regional development sends a strong signal to the market and will help unlock the next wave of investments, analysts said on Tuesday.

The UP Cabinet, chaired by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on Monday, approved the Data Centre policy. The earlier policy had expired on January 27 this year, following which the government decided to introduce the new one to develop the State as a green and AI-ready data centre hub with an additional capacity of 2 GW.

For balanced development, Bundelkhand and Purvanchal will receive addi-

tional incentives, investment target of over ₹2 lakh crore, the State government said, adding that there is a possibility of indirect employment for around 50,000 people under policy.

“The new policy places special emphasis on GPU-based infrastructure, energy efficiency, and sustainable development. In addition, extra incentives have been proposed for the Bundelkhand and Purvanchal regions. The policy includes provisions such as incentives for Tier/Rating-3 and 4 Data Centres, AI Compute Booster incentives, and Green and Sustainable Operations incentives,” State IT and Electronics Minister Sunil Sharma, said.

The Yogi government had implemented the UP Data Centre Policy-2021 in January 2021, which was subsequently amended on November 7, 2022. Under the UP Data Centre Policy-2021 (First Amend-



KEY DECISION. The UP Cabinet, chaired by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, approved the policy on Monday

ment-2022), out of six Data centre Parks and two Data Centre units with a capacity of less than 40 MW involving an investment of around ₹21,343 crore and seven projects have already become operational, Sharma added.

NEXT PRIORITY

“The next priority should be swift implementation, robust power and connectivity infrastructure, and close collaboration between government and industry to translate these ambitions into scalable capacity and long-

term economic value,” Shalini Dawar, Partner and Leader, Data Centre at EY-Parthenon, told *businessline*.

She added India is entering a new phase of AI adoption and is poised to become one of the world's fastest-growing markets for AI infrastructure. While strong commitments from hyperscale cloud providers, data centre operators and financial investors are already driving momentum, policy support is essential to accelerate deployment at scale, reduce investment friction and create

globally competitive infrastructure ecosystems.

“UP has already proved its mettle in mobile manufacturing. It has the Samsung's largest plant, so does it have plants of Vivo, Oppo, and others... This proven track record definitely puts UP ahead of many other States. It has the scale to offer as well as record to show. The data centre story will further give it an impetus and help UP emerge as a strong State on the technology and digital pathways,” Paisal Kawoosa, Chief Analyst and Founder at Techarc, said. According to Piyush Somani, Promoter, Managing Director and Chairman, ESDS Software Solution, this strategic initiative has the potential to catalyse an entire digital economy by attracting large-scale investments, accelerating innovation and generating high-value employment across cloud computing, AI and advanced digital infrastructure.

Mudslide at Wayanad tunnel site leaves three dead, several missing



MONSOON HAVOC. Debris clearance underway following the landslide at the Wayanad-Kalladi tunnel construction site

Our Bureau
Kochi

At least three people were reported dead and several missing after a massive mudslide, triggered by torrential monsoon rain, struck a tunnel construction site near Meenakshi Bridge in Wayanad, Kerala, on Tuesday.

Officials said 18 people were caught in the mudslide. Five were rescued from the debris and 10 injured persons have been admitted to WIMS Hospital in Meppadi for treatment.

Those affected include workers on the tunnel road project, security personnel and supervisory staff.

The mudslide occurred near Meenakshi Bridge before noon, where construction of the Anakkampoyil-Kalladi-Meppadi twin tunnel project is underway to connect Malappuram and Wayanad districts.

RESCUE OPERATION

A largescale rescue operation is underway involving personnel from the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF), the Kerala Police and the Fire and Rescue Services to trace those missing.

The accident site is located near Mundakkai, the same area worst affected during the devastating Wayanad landslides of 2024.

Government officials said preliminary findings indicate that the mudslide was caused

by unscientifically stacked excavated soil. They alleged that the contractor's failure to remove the accumulated earth in a timely manner contributed to the disaster.

Chief Minister VD Satheesan reviewed the situation and directed Ministers AP Anil Kumar and T Siddique to proceed immediately to Wayanad to oversee the rescue operations.

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi expressed grief over the incident and urged the authorities to make every possible effort to rescue those still trapped.

CONTRACTORS REACT

Dilip Buildcon Ltd, the contractors for the Anakkampoyil-Kalladi-Meppadi Tunnel project, said that it is being executed in strict compliance with all applicable engineering, safety and environmental approvals and protocols. Given its location in an ecologically sensitive region, the project is subject to multiple regulatory oversights and monitoring mechanisms, including supervision by the Supreme Court-appointed Central Empowered Committee, and all excavated material is handled in accordance with the approved methodology.

With such additional and strict compliance procedures the room for technical error remains very limited, the company said in a filing to the BSE.

SC junks DMK plea to stop TVK statements on Karur stampede

Krishnadas Rajagopal
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday said imposing a judicial bar on Tamil Nadu's ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) leaders from making public statements linking political rivals with the Karur stampede may amount to an injunction on “free speech”.

The court advised Opposition Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) to make its own counter speeches, and battle “free speech” with “more speech”, rather than try for a judicial gag.

The remarks by a Bench,

headed by Justice KV Viswanathan, came during the hearing of an application filed by DMK Organising Secretary RS Bharathi, alleging that TVK Ministers like Aadhav Arjuna were “publicly making false accusations of criminal liability and threats against political opponents” in connection with the Karur stampede.

The tragedy left 41 dead and 142 injured during a TVK rally on September 27 last year. The top court had ordered a CBI investigation into the incident on October 13, 2025. The probe is continuing and some TVK leaders have been named as ac-



cused. Senior advocate Ranjit Kumar, appearing for Bharathi, said TVK ministers like Arjuna, an accused in the case, must be restrained from making any such public statements during the pen-

dency of the investigation.

“That may amount to an injunction on free speech, Kumar. Which law sanctions it? You also make your speeches, you counter free speech with more speech,” Justice Viswanathan said.

The Bench questioned the propriety of entertaining a DMK plea for impleadment in a case in which it had ordered CBI investigation and was monitoring progress.

‘CHECK YOUR FACTS’

Further, Kumar objected to Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay's likely visit to Karur on July 10 to meet the

families of the stampede victims and to hand over compassionate appointments to them. He said the State government had already announced *ex-gratia* payment of ₹10 lakh to the affected families. Kumar claimed a “narrative is being built by the accused persons. I am not against the compensation, I am against compensation being given directly by the accused to the families, who are also witnesses in the case.”

The court said Vijay was neither arraigned as an ‘accused’ in the FIRs nor in the DMK's own application. “You please check up on your

facts,” Justice Viswanathan said. The judge asked how the Supreme Court was expected to “regulate the itinerary” of the Chief Minister.

“If the executive head is travelling to merely distribute what has already been ordered for the victims by the State government, how will the victims be influenced? Does it not really reflect your thoughts on the victims?”

Justice Viswanathan asked, voicing a doubt whether the application was “well-thought through” in the first place.

Kumar, acting on instructions, finally chose to withdraw the application.

Development curbs around Pallikaranai marsh to hit one lakh landowners: Credai

Our Bureau
Chennai

Restrictions imposed around the Pallikaranai Ramsar site could impact nearly ₹72,000 crore worth of economic activity in Chennai and affect more than one lakh patta landowners, according to Credai Chennai.

The real estate industry body on Tuesday urged the Tamil Nadu government to review the blanket 1 km development freeze around the internationally recognised wetland.

The developers' body, Confederation of Real Estate Developers Associations of India, said the current restrictions have effectively stalled real estate activity in parts of the city's southern growth corridor over the past nine months, affecting residential and commercial developments, industries, financial institutions and property owners.

According to Credai's assessment, the planning freeze could affect ₹51,735.88 crore worth of real estate business. It also estimated a direct revenue loss to the government of ₹10,995.38 crore through stamp duty, registration



Mehul H Doshi, President, Credai-Chennai and Viswajith Kumar, Vice-President, at a press conference in Chennai

charges and other levies, besides an indirect economic impact of ₹8,795.10 crore. Together, these take the overall economic implication to nearly ₹72,000 crore.

Mehul H Doshi, President of CREDAI Chennai, said the industry body's concern is not with the 698-hectare Pallikaranai Swamp Reserve Forest, which has been protected since 2007, or even the 1,248-hectare Ramsar site. Instead, the issue relates to an additional 550 hectares that has been brought under the notification without clear identification or survey number demarcation.

PLANNING FREEZE

More than one lakh patta owners have been impacted because of this uncertainty, Doshi said. Viswajith Kumar,

Vice-President of Credai Chennai, said that the uniform 1 km influence zone around the Ramsar site had created a planning freeze over a much larger urban area without adequate scientific assessment.

It said the influence zone should instead be determined through hydrological studies, drainage patterns, topography, land-use assessment and field validation rather than by applying a blanket buffer.

INFRA PROJECTS

Kumar pointed out that the 1 km zone covers several major public infrastructure projects, including Chennai Metro Rail Phase II stations, existing MRTS stations and the proposed integrated transit hub at Sholinganallur.

TN to regularise jobs of 23,000 Tasmac retail staff

Press Trust of India
Chennai

The state-owned Tasmac, the monopoly liquor trade agency in Tamil Nadu, has proposed to regularise the services of over 23,000 contract workers employed at its liquor outlets with a salary hike.

The Tamil Nadu State Marketing Corporation (Tasmac) has 38 district offices, 43 Indian made foreign liquor depots, 4,787 retail vending shops, and 2,362 bars attached to retail vending shops, as per the 2025-2026 policy note of the Home Prohibition and Excise Department. The contract workers, including shop supervisors, get a consolidated pay of ₹17,800 per month, salesmen ₹15,300, and assistant salesmen ₹14,300.

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thehindu businessline.

TN to launch online property registration from August 17

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Tamil Nadu government has approved the first phase of its ‘Anywhere Registration’ initiative under the upgraded STAR 3.0 platform, making two categories of property transactions mandatory through a fully paperless, presenceless registration process from August 17, 2026. Under a Government Order issued on Tuesday, the Commercial Taxes, Registration and Religious Endowments Depart-

ment accorded administrative sanction for the implementation of Phase I of the initiative.

Initially, the mandate will cover the first sale of plots and apartments by promoters and builders, along with the subsequent deposit of title deeds, eliminating the need for parties to visit Sub-Registrar offices in person.

Executants and attesting witnesses will be required to submit biometric thumb impressions, digital fingerprints, photographs and Aadhaar details.

ESAF
ESAF SMALL FINANCE BANK

REGD. OFFICE: ESAF Bhavan, Mannuthy, Thrissur - 680 651, Kerala

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DATE OF AUCTION: 21-07-2026

TIME: 11 am to 06 pm

AUCTION VENUE: THROUGH E-AUCTION

AUCTION ADDRESS: <https://gold.matextnet.org>

Contact No: 9944171360 / 9843312694

To register as bidder for the e-Auction with terms and conditions, and full details of e-Auction please visit the above site.

BRANCH NAME & LOAN ACCOUNT NUMBERS

Anamalai: 75250004070649, Dharmapuri: 75250004342058, Batlagundu: 63260000039186, Erode: 75250004333265, Sathyamangalam: 75250004195414, 4470616, Hosur: 63260000045635, Gudalur: 75250004373349, Palayamkottai -Tirunelveli: 75250004349655, 5050440, Tindivanam: 75250004184345, 5009449, Puduchery: 75250004476085.

Customers who are interested to release the ornaments by paying the total due amount may do so, at the respective branches, on or two days before the date of the auction. Bidders who wish to participate in the auction shall produce their KYC documents. GST No. is mandatory for registered firms/companies. Bidders shall deposit a sum of **Rs.50,000** as EMD before participating in the auction.

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ICICIPRAMC-IPRUS008	59.92	59.85	380.44	63.90	51.17	-
ICICIPRAMC-PSUBANKICI	84.76	84.48	212.37	104.00	67.86	-
ICICIPRU SENETf	899.96	897.14	18.76	999.84	731.00	-
ICICIPRUDENGOLDETF	123.75	122.97	2980.72	158.00	81.26	-

13.30	KtakMAMC-MNC	34.17	33.94	86.26	35.54	27.83	-
-	KtakMAMC-Sil	22.39	21.94	5845.46	388.00	17.77	-
-	KtakMAMC-Vol	21.18	21.27	1661.18	22.90	18.77	-
-	KtakMAMC-PKET	60.52	60.40	222.24	652.87	51.71	-

Company	Pre CI	NSE CI	Vol	S2 WH	S2 WL	BSE CI	MIRAEAMC - HEALTHCARE	21.33	21.14	40.34	22.21	17.18	-
							MIRAEAMC INERA	12.42	12.22	16.00	12.27	10.14	

-	MOTILALAMC - MOENFR	53.57	53.25	53.25	43.00	55.00
-	MOTILALAMC - MOGOLD	143.15	142.05	179.29	175.00	96.30
-	MOTILALAMC - MOINFRA	62.70	62.14	3.51	66.00	54.60
-	MOTILALAMC - MOIPO	46.09	46.35	1.18	53.00	36.50
-	MOTILALAMC - MOINFR	53.57	53.25	53.25	43.00	55.00

-	NIPPONAMC-SNXT30BEEES	42.47	42.50	14.81	43.75	36.83	-
-	NIPPONAMC-NETFAUTO	281.97	281.91	167.08	299.92	238.11	-
-	NIPPONAMC-NETFSIL	220.36	216.29	19785.98	360.00	103.07	-

82.26	UTIAMC-BANKBETA	66.22	66.30	192.28	73.70	31.30	-
-	UTIAMC-GILT10BETA	26.77	26.76	0.41	27.14	25.10	-
-	UTIAMC-GILT5BETA	66.48	66.80	0.34	66.81	61.51	-
-	UTIAMC-ITBETA	285.97	293.09	1.75	409.94	270.68	-

Cl	Company	Pr Cl		Cl	Company	Pr Cl		Cl	Company	Pr Cl		Cl
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162.45	Company	Pr Cl	Cl	Company	Pr Cl	Cl	Company	Pr Cl	Cl
261.15									
589.90									
0.43	ADVT JEWELS	168.24	169.19	Gavatri Proi [2]	21.26	20.95	PRIME FO [1]	234.54	235.39

